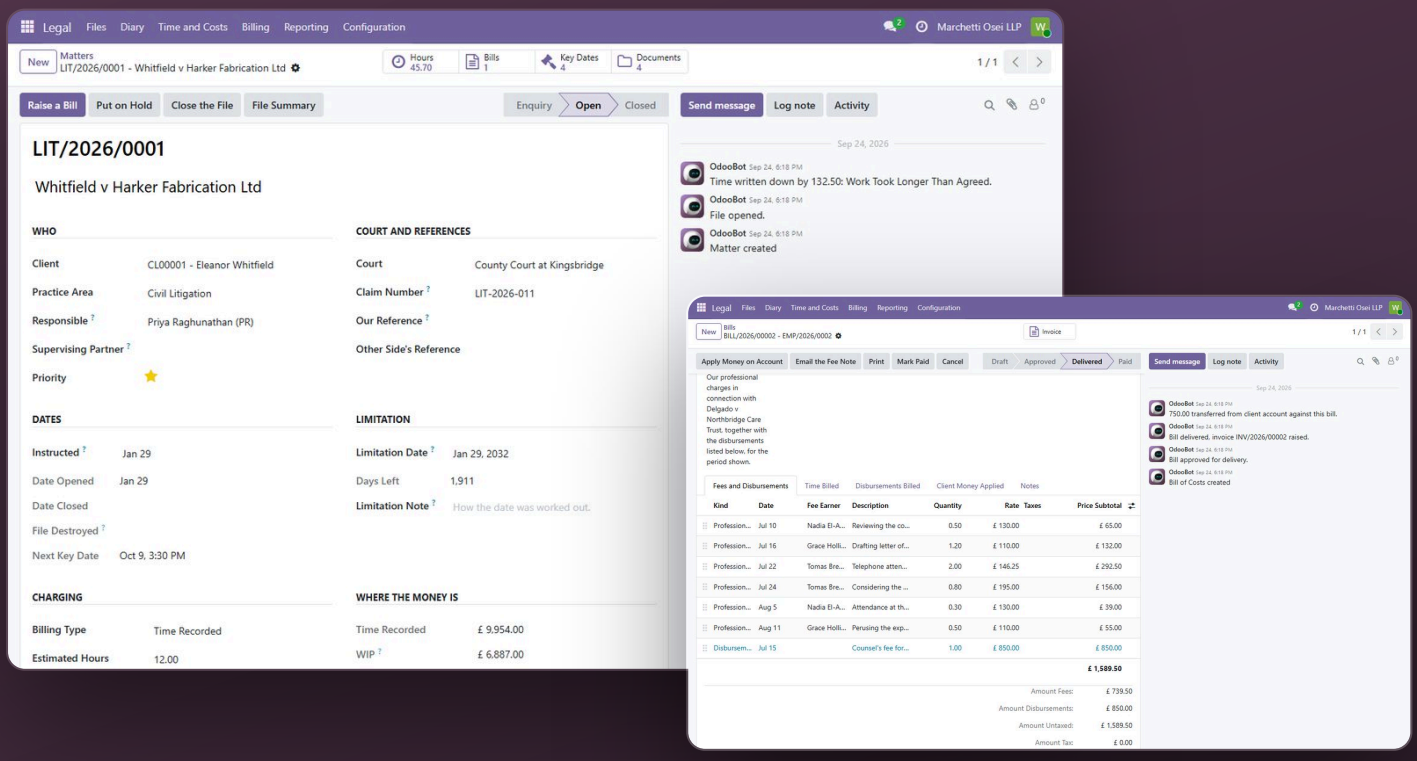
WAY4TECH SOLUTIONS

Live demo
legal-demo.way4tech.com
w4demo / Demo2026 · Odoo 19, Community

COMPLETE GUIDE · THE PRACTICE, SETUP AND EVERY SCREEN

Law Firm Management for Odoo 19

Conflict checks, matters and the limitation diary, time on a rate card, disbursements, a client account that cannot go overdrawn, and bills of costs that post to Odoo accounting. Every screen and every step, shown on a live demo. No Odoo background needed.



START

About this guide

A law firm sells time and holds other people's money. Almost every rule in practice management comes back to one of those two facts. This guide shows how the Law Firm Management module for Odoo 19 runs a practice on them, from the first phone call to the day the bill is paid, one screen at a time. You do not need to have used Odoo before.

Who it is for

The partner or practice manager setting the firm up, the fee earners who record time and run files, the cashier who keeps the client account and raises bills, and anyone being shown the system for the first time.

How to read it

Front to back the first time. Each part opens with what you will learn and a short thing to try on the live demo, then walks every field, button and rule on every screen.

The live demo

Marchetti Osei LLP, an invented six fee earner practice with litigation, employment, conveyancing, family, corporate and probate work, already full of files, time, bills and client money. Open it and follow along.

HOW IT WORKS

The demo practice

Address	**legal-demo.way4tech.com**
Sign in	**w4demo** / **Demo2026**
Practice	Marchetti Osei LLP · six fee earners, six departments, eleven files
Website demo	**lawfirm.way4tech.com** (the same module, plus the Law Firm website theme)
Runs on	Odoo 19, Community edition, with Invoicing

What you are buying

MODULE	WHAT IT ADDS	BADGE IN THIS GUIDE
Law Firm Management (wt_legal_practice)	Everything in Parts 1 to 16: conflict checks, matters, the diary, the document register, time, disbursements, client money, bills of costs and the reports. Needs only Invoicing, which it installs.	CORE
Law Firm Website Theme (wt_theme_lawfirm)	A separate, optional website theme: a ready home page, About, Services and Contact pages and nine law firm snippets. Part 17.	WEBSITE THEME

The demo is shared and resets from time to time, so anything you change may be put back or seen by the next visitor. Treat it as a practice to walk around, not your own books.

What is in the guide

PART 1	How a law firm runs a file	PART 2	The practice at a glance
PART 3	Open the demo and sign in	PART 4	Set the practice up from zero
PART 5	Taking on a client	PART 6	The conflict check
PART 7	Opening and running a matter	PART 8	The diary and the limitation date
PART 9	The document register	PART 10	Recording time

PART 11 Disbursements

PART 12 The client account

PART 13 Bills of costs

PART 14 Reporting

PART 15 Printed documents and emails

PART 16 What runs by itself

PART 17 The firm's website WEBSITE THEME

PART 18 A fifteen minute walk-through

PART 19 The menu map

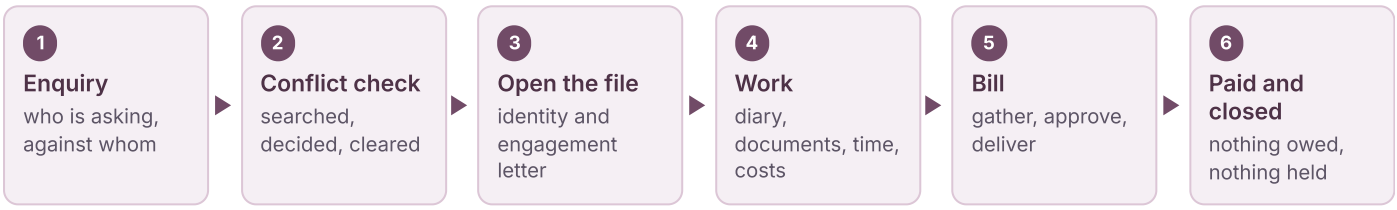
PART 1 How a law firm runs a file

Before the screens, the trade. A solicitors' practice has a small number of things it must get right every time, and every one of them has a screen in this module. If you know the trade already, skim this part for the words the system uses.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Why nothing opens before a conflict check and an identity check
- What a matter is, and why everything hangs off it
- The limitation date, and why it is the most dangerous date in the diary
- Time, the rate card, and why six minutes is the usual unit
- Disbursements, client money and bills of costs, and why they are kept apart
- Work in progress, realisation and lock-up: the three numbers a partner manages

The life of a file



The conflict check comes first

A firm may not act against a client it already acts for, and may not act for two people whose interests clash. So before a new piece of work is taken on, the names on both sides are searched against everything the firm holds: its clients, the parties recorded on every file, and the names of the files themselves. The search, what it found and who decided what are kept as a record, because when the question is asked years later it is always who ran it and what it turned up.

Know who the client is

Money laundering rules mean a firm must see evidence of who its client is, and a signed engagement letter is what gives it an agreed basis for charging. The module will not give a file a number until both are on the client record. Both checks can be switched off in the settings for a firm that runs them elsewhere.

The matter

A **matter** (or file) is one piece of work for one client. It carries the department (the **practice area**), the fee earner responsible, the partner supervising, the court, the other side and the limitation date. Time, disbursements, bills, documents, key dates and client money all belong to a matter, which is why every screen in this guide leads back to it.

The date that ends the claim

Most claims must be issued within a fixed period, the **limitation period**, or they are lost for good. Six years is usual for contract claims in England and Wales, three months less a day for most employment tribunal claims. Missing a limitation date is the classic negligence claim against a solicitor, so the module proposes the date from the practice area, keeps one per file, will not let it be vacated or deleted, and warns the fee earner months ahead.

Time and the rate card

A fee earner records time against the file in units, normally six minutes (a tenth of an hour). Each unit is charged at a rate: the rate agreed with that client, or the department's rate, or the fee earner's own standard rate. Time that is

recorded but not yet billed is **work in progress (WIP)**. Time can be written down or written off before it is billed, and every write-off needs a reason.

Disbursements are not fees

A **disbursement** is money laid out for the client: a court fee, counsel, an expert, a search. The firm recovers it pound for pound, so it is not the firm's income, does not count towards a fee cap, and is shown apart from fees on the bill.

Client money is somebody else's

Money a client pays on account belongs to the client until the firm has delivered a bill for it. It is kept in a separate **client account**, one ledger per client, which can never go below nothing, and it may only be moved to the firm's own office account against a bill that has already gone out.

The bill of costs

A bill gathers the unbilled time and disbursements off one file for a period, under a covering narrative the client reads first. Fees, disbursements and tax are shown apart from one another, then anything already taken from money on account, then what is now payable. Delivering it raises an ordinary Odoo customer invoice.

Three numbers a partner manages

Work in progress

Recorded, chargeable and not yet billed. The value sitting on the files that has not turned into a bill.

Realisation

Fees billed as a percentage of the time recorded. The gap is the write-offs and write-downs.

Lock-up

Days the oldest unbilled work has waited, plus days the oldest delivered bill has been unpaid. Cash the firm has earned but does not have.

PART 2 The practice at a glance

The module adds one app, Legal, with six menus. This part is the map and the people. Every later part is one area in full.

Four roles

Each user gets one level under **Legal Practice** in their user settings. Each level includes the ones before it where shown.

ROLE	WHAT THEY SEE AND DO
Fee Earner	Their own files (where they are the responsible fee earner or the supervisor), their own time, the diary and documents on their files, bills on their files, and, read only, the client account of every client they are relationship partner for. Can run conflict checks and take on clients.
Cashier	Every file read only, every bill and the whole client account and ledger. Can read every time entry in order to bill it, but never edit one. Sees the Client Ledger menu.
Supervising Partner	Includes Fee Earner and Cashier. Every file and every entry, the client due diligence notes and the politically exposed flag, settlement authority, write-offs over the limit and the Reporting menu.
Practice Manager	Includes Supervising Partner. The Configuration menu: fee earners, the rate card, practice areas, courts and disbursement types. Settings also need Odoo's own Administration rights.

> A conflict search deliberately ignores these limits and looks across every file in the practice, because a check that only saw the searcher's own files would miss the matter in the department down the corridor. A match on a file the reader cannot open is shown as "another file".

The six menus

Files

Matters	Every file, from enquiry to closed
Clients	Who the firm acts for, and the due diligence
Conflict Checks	Names searched, matches decided, cleared
Document Register	What is on each file and where originals are

Diary

Key Dates and Hearings	Hearings, deadlines, completions, reviews
Limitation Dates	Every live limitation date in the practice

Time and Costs

Time Recording	Timer, rate card, write-downs and write-offs
Disbursements	Money laid out, from office or client account

Billing

Bills	Gather, approve, deliver, apply money, paid
Client Accounts	One ledger per client, never overdrawn
Client Ledger	Every client money entry (cashier)

Reporting

Work in Progress	Unbilled time by fee earner and department
Realisation and Lock-up	Billed against recorded, days of cash locked up
Billing	Delivered and paid bills by month

Configuration

Settings	The seven practice rules
Fee Earners	People who record time, grades and targets
Rate Card	Rates by fee earner, department and client
Practice Areas	Departments, prefixes, limitation periods
Courts and Tribunals	Where the firm appears, and filing notes
Disbursement Types	Defaults and the recovery account

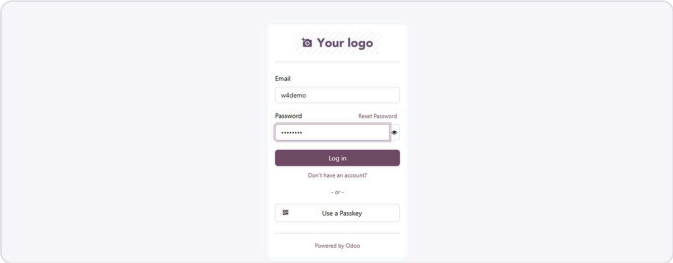
> The demo login w4demo is a Practice Manager and is linked to the fee earner Priya Raghunathan, so you can follow every part of this guide and the "My" filters show her files and time.

PART 3 Open the demo and sign in

Everything in this guide can be followed on the live demo. It is a real Odoo 19 database for an invented firm, Marchetti Osei LLP, already filled with clients, files, a year of time, bills and client money.

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

1. Open legal-demo.way4tech.com in any browser
2. Sign in with w4demo and Demo2026
3. Open the app menu and click Legal
4. Click Files, then Matters: you are on the screen in Part 7



1

Go to the practice

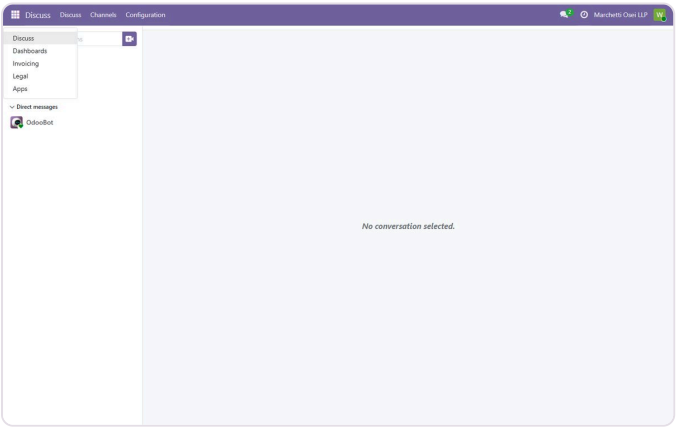
Open **legal-demo.way4tech.com**. The sign-in screen is the standard Odoo one. There is nothing to install and nothing to pay.

lawfirm.way4tech.com runs the same module with the website theme on top. Its back office works the same way.

2

Sign in

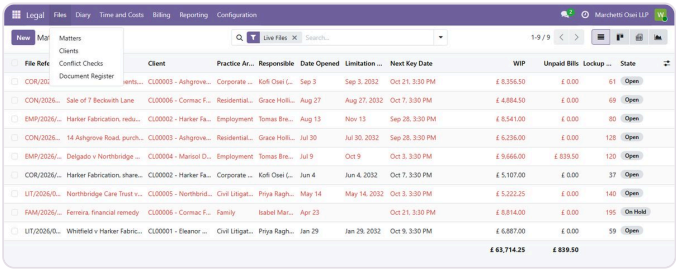
User `w4demo`, password `Demo2026`. This login is a Practice Manager, so it can see every screen in this guide. A real fee earner would see far less.



3

Open Legal

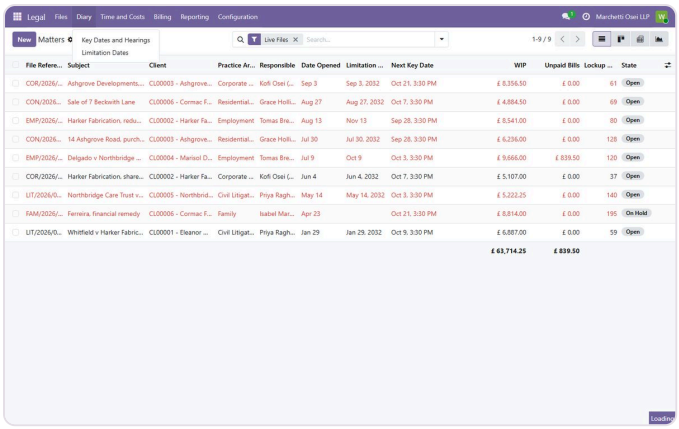
Click the grid of squares at the top left to open the app menu, then **Legal**. The app is the scales of justice icon.



4

Files

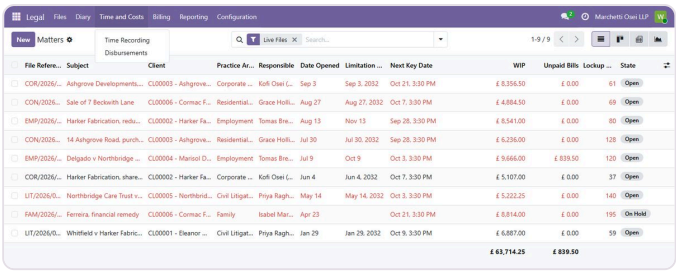
Matters, Clients, Conflict Checks and the Document Register. This is where a file starts and where it lives.



5

Diary

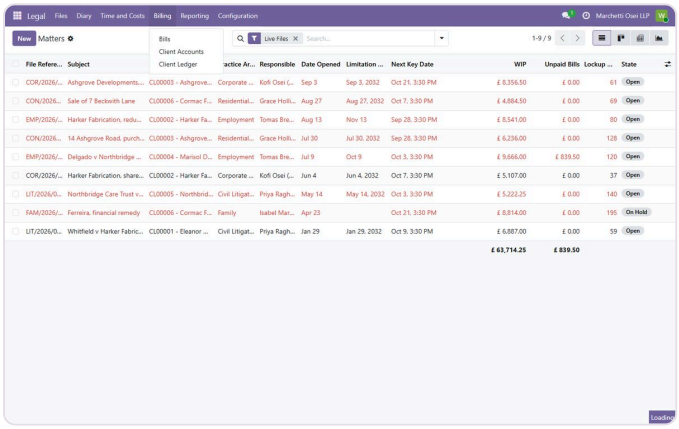
Key Dates and Hearings, and the Limitation Dates on their own.



6

Time and Costs

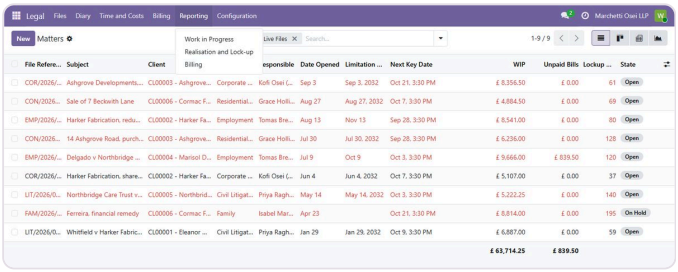
Time Recording and Disbursements: everything that becomes work in progress.



7

Billing

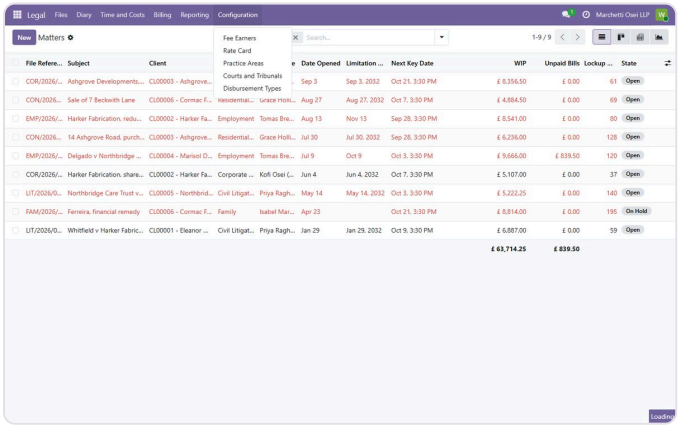
Bills, Client Accounts and, for the cashier, the Client Ledger.



8

Reporting

Work in Progress, Realisation and Lock-up, and Billing. Partners and the practice manager only.



9

Configuration

Settings, Fee Earners, Rate Card, Practice Areas, Courts and Tribunals, Disbursement Types. Practice manager only.

PART 4 Set the practice up from zero

What a new firm does on day one, before it takes on a single client: install the app, set the seven practice rules, then enter its departments, courts, people, rates and disbursement types. On the demo this is already done, so read it to see what each setting means and where it lives.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Installing Law Firm Management and what it brings with it
- The seven practice settings, what each one does, and the default
- Practice areas: the matter prefix, limitation period, default rate and income account
- Courts and tribunals, fee earners and their grades and targets
- The rate card and the order in which a rate is chosen
- Disbursement types, user roles and how records are numbered

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

1. Open Legal, then Configuration, then Settings and read the seven rules
2. Open Practice Areas and compare the limitation years of Litigation and Employment
3. Open Rate Card and expand one fee earner

Install the app

The module is called **Law Firm Management** (technical name wt_legal_practice). Open Apps, search for it and press Install. It depends only on Discuss and Invoicing, both in Odoo Community, and installs them if they are not there. The installer also loads six practice areas, seven disbursement types, the numbering sequences, two email templates and seven scheduled jobs, and makes the administrator a Practice Manager.

Set the practice rules

Legal, then Configuration, then Settings. The seven rules are company settings, so each firm in a group can have its own.

> The Settings page needs Odoo's Administration rights as well as Practice Manager, so the shared demo login cannot open it. The page has four blocks, Taking On Work, The Diary, Time and Write-offs and Cash and Billing, holding the seven rules below.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES	DEFAULT
Conflict Check Before Opening	A matter will not open until a conflict check has been run and cleared and is linked on the file. Turn it off only if searches are run in another system.	On
Client Due Diligence Before Opening	A matter will not open until the client's identity is verified and the date of the signed engagement letter is on the client.	On
Limitation Warnings	How many days before a limitation date the diary raises an activity for the fee earner. It becomes the warning period on every new limitation entry.	90 days
Charging Unit	What the timer rounds up to when it is stopped. Six minutes is a tenth of an hour.	6 minutes
Write-off Limit	The largest write-off or write-down a fee earner may make on their own. Above it, only a Supervising Partner can do it.	250.00
Lock-up Target	Days of unbilled work plus unpaid bills the firm will carry on a file. Files over it show red and the weekly job chases the fee earner.	60 days

Billing Journal	The sales journal bills post to. Leave it empty for the company's default sales journal. A journal in another currency is refused at delivery.	Empty

Practice areas

Configuration, then Practice Areas. A practice area is a department. It does four jobs:

Code

Goes in front of every matter number: LIT/2026/0001. Litigation, Employment, Residential Conveyancing, Family, Corporate and Commercial and Wills and Probate come ready.

Contentious and limitation

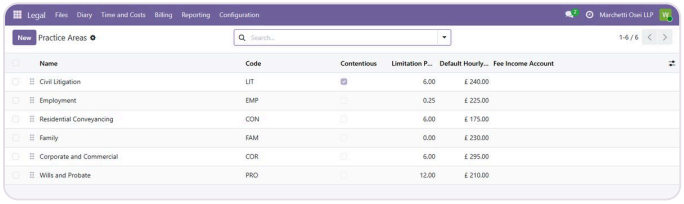
A contentious area needs a court on the file before it opens. The limitation period in years (0.25 is three months) proposes the limitation date from the day of instruction.

Default rate

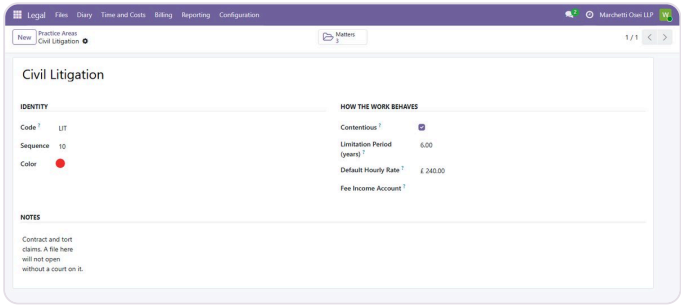
Used when the rate card has no line for the fee earner, before falling back to their standard rate.

Fee income account

Where the fee lines of a bill post. Disbursements go to their own account instead.



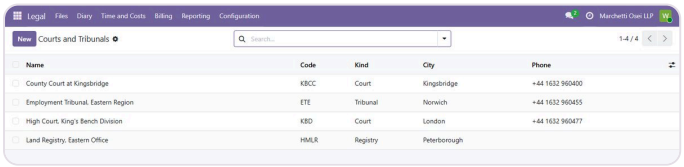
The six departments, editable in the list.



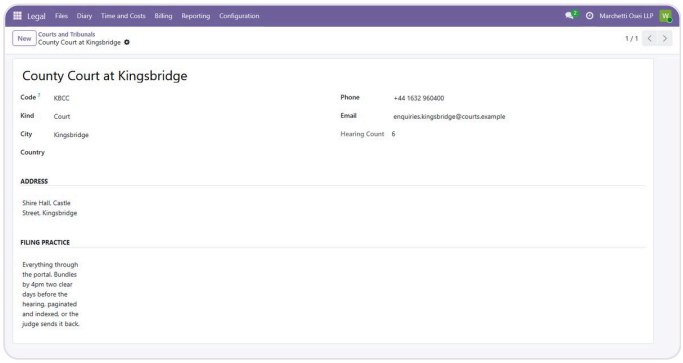
A practice area, with a button to its matters.

Courts and tribunals

Configuration, then Courts and Tribunals. Each court has a code, a kind (court, tribunal, registry, arbitration, mediation or regulator), a city and country, phone, email, address and a filing note for its local practice. Courts are address book entries: nothing is filed electronically.



The courts the firm appears in.

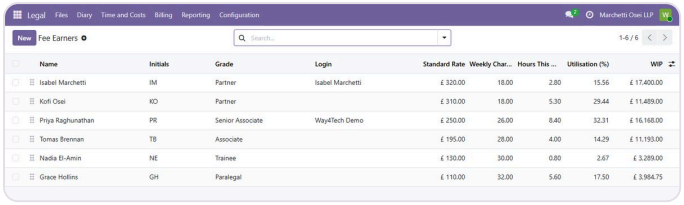


A court, with how many key dates are listed there.

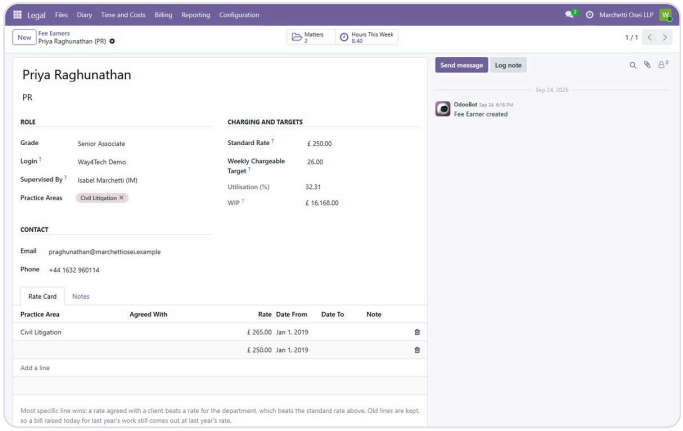
Fee earners

Configuration, then Fee Earners. A fee earner is anybody who records time: name, initials (they go on the bill lines and become the default "our reference" on a new file), grade (partner, of counsel, senior associate, associate, trainee, paralegal, consultant), the Odoo user they sign in as, their supervisor, the practice areas they work in, a standard hourly rate and a weekly chargeable target. Linking the user matters: the record rules, the "My" filters and every reminder find people through it.

The form works out **hours this week** (chargeable time dated since Monday, drafts included, written-off time left out), **utilisation** (those hours against the target) and the fee earner's **WIP**. Nobody may be their own supervisor.



Fee earners with grade, rate, target, hours this week and utilisation.



A senior associate, supervised by a partner.

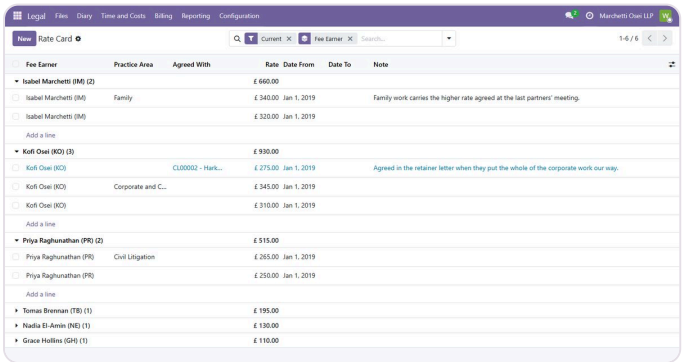
The rate card

Every time entry is priced from the rate card on the day the work was done. A line belongs to a fee earner and may be narrowed to a practice area, to a client who negotiated a rate, or both, from a start date to an optional end date. Old lines are kept, so a bill raised today for last year's work comes out at last year's rate. Two lines covering the same day for the same combination are refused.

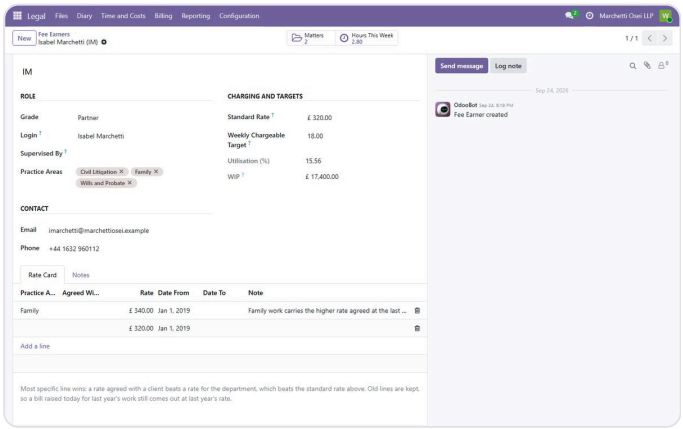
HOW IT WORKS

Which rate is charged

1	A line agreed with this client for this practice area
2	A line agreed with this client for any work
3	The fee earner's line for this practice area
4	The fee earner's general line
5	The practice area's default rate
6	The fee earner's standard rate on their form



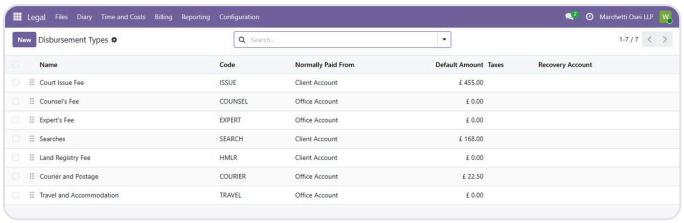
Configuration, then Rate Card: current lines grouped by fee earner. Lines agreed with a client show in blue.



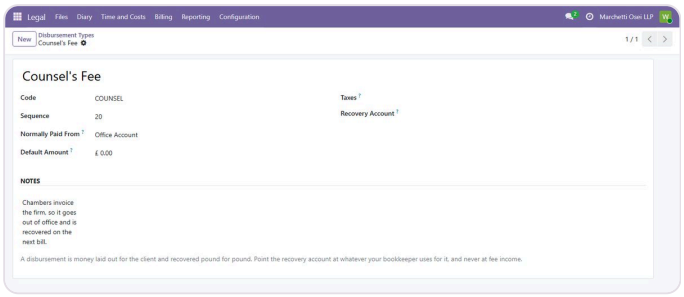
The same lines on the fee earner's own Rate Card tab.

Disbursement types

Configuration, then Disbursement Types. Court Issue Fee, Counsel's Fee, Expert's Fee, Searches, Land Registry Fee, Courier and Postage and Travel and Accommodation come ready. Each type sets the default "paid from" (office or client account), a default amount, default taxes and the **recovery account** it posts to on a bill. Point that at the account your bookkeeper uses for recoverable disbursements, never at fee income.



The seven disbursement types.



Counsel's fee: paid from office, with its recovery account.

Give people their roles

In Odoo's Settings, then Users, open each person and set **Legal Practice** to Fee Earner, Cashier, Supervising Partner or Practice Manager (Part 2). Then link them to their fee earner record.

How records are numbered

RECORD	NUMBER	EXAMPLE
Client	CL and five digits	CL00003
Matter	Practice area code, year, four digits	LIT/2026/0001
Conflict check	CON, year, four digits	CON/2026/0012
Bill of costs	BILL, year, five digits	BILL/2026/00001
Client ledger entry	CA, year, six digits	CA/2026/000004
Document	DOC and seven digits	DOC0000001

PART 5 Taking on a client

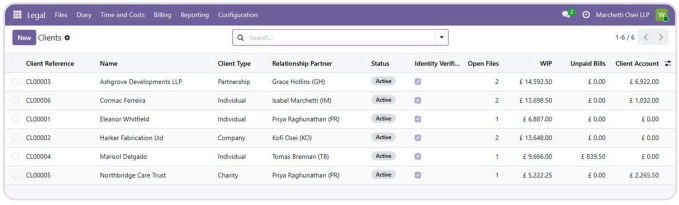
A client record is the person or organisation the firm acts for, with the due diligence the firm did on them. It is built on an ordinary Odoo contact, so the address book, invoices and email all work as normal.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Creating a client and the fields that matter on day one
- Recording the identity check, and why it needs a reference
- Risk rating, politically exposed persons and the partners' notes
- The client's matters, client money and conflict checks in one place

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

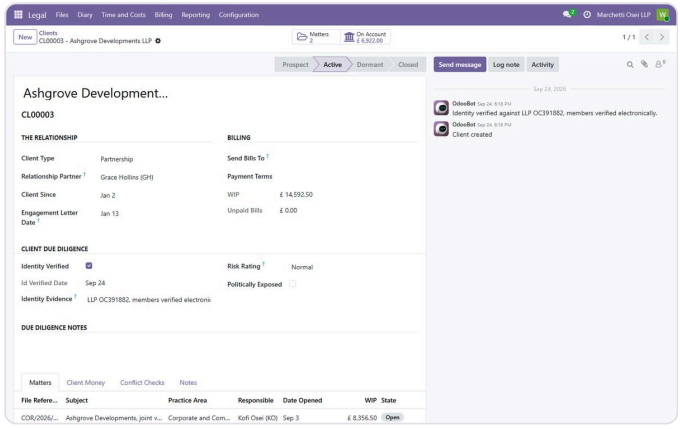
1. Open Files, then Clients, and open Ashgrove Developments LLP
2. Read its due diligence block, then click the On Account button
3. Back on the list, try the Identity Not Verified filter



1

The client list

Files, then Clients. Each client has its reference, type, relationship partner, status, whether identity is verified, open files, WIP, unpaid bills and money held on account. A client whose identity is not verified shows in amber.

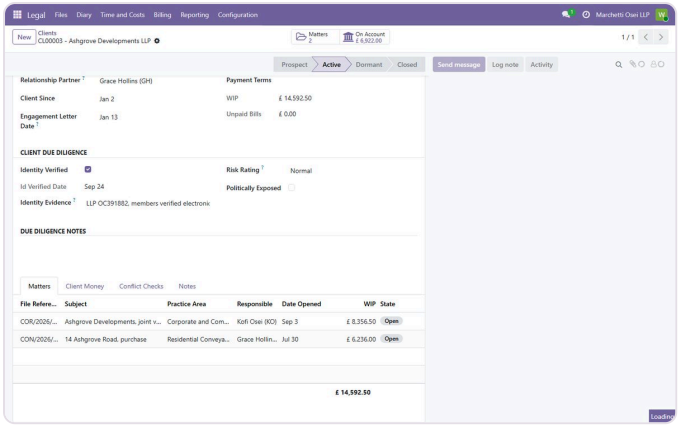


2

Create the client

Press New and pick or create the **contact**. The reference (CL00001 and on) is given on save. Set the **client type** (individual, company, partnership, trust, estate, charity or public body), the **relationship partner** (required), the date they became a client and, once it is back, the date of the signed **engagement letter**. Under Billing, set who the bills go to if it is not the client, and the payment terms used on the invoice.

The engagement letter cannot be dated before the client existed. A new client starts as a Prospect and becomes Active by itself when their first file opens. Dormant and Closed are set by clicking the status bar.

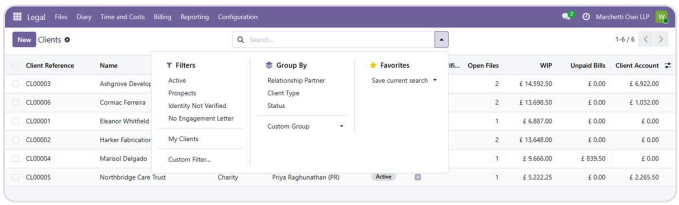


3

Record the identity check

Under Client Due Diligence, write what you saw in **Identity Evidence**: a passport number, an electronic check reference, "certified copy on file". Then press **Record Identity Check** in the header. It ticks Identity Verified, stamps today's date and posts a note in the chatter. Without a reference written down the button refuses.

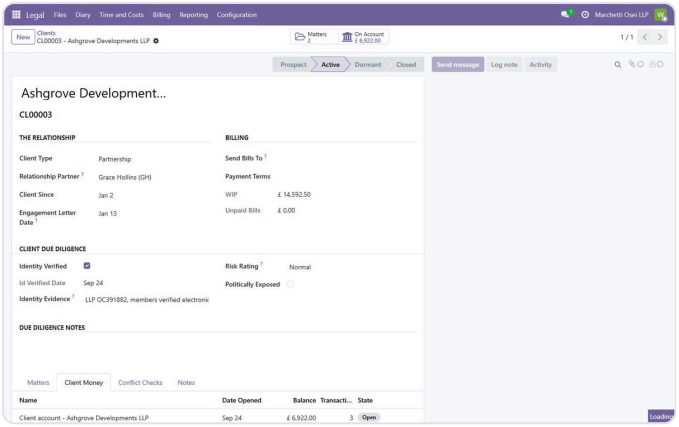
Set the **risk rating** (low, normal, high). The **Politically Exposed** tick and the **Due Diligence Notes** are only visible to partners and the practice manager.



5

Find the gaps

Filters for Active, Prospects, Identity Not Verified, No Engagement Letter and My Clients, and grouping by relationship partner, type and status. The two gap filters are the ones a compliance review starts with.



4

Matters, client money and checks

The tabs list the client's matters with their WIP, the client account and its balance, every conflict check raised for them, and free notes. The **Matters** button opens their files, and the **On Account** button (cashier and above) opens the client account, creating it the first time it is pressed.

PART 6 The conflict check

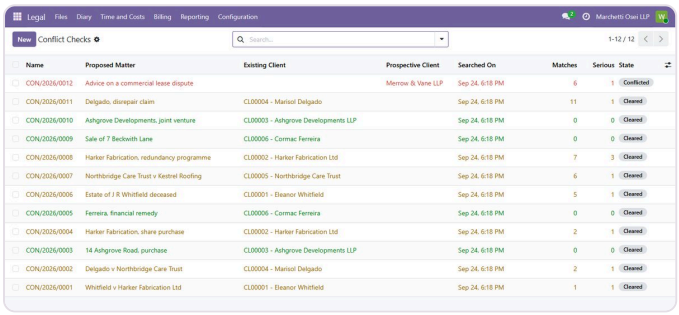
Before a file can open, the names on both sides are searched against every client, every recorded party and every file the firm holds. The check is a record of its own: who ran it, when, what it found and what was decided.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Raising a check for a new or existing client
- What is searched, and how each match is graded
- Reviewing serious matches and writing the reason to go ahead
- Clearing a check, marking it conflicted, and resetting it

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

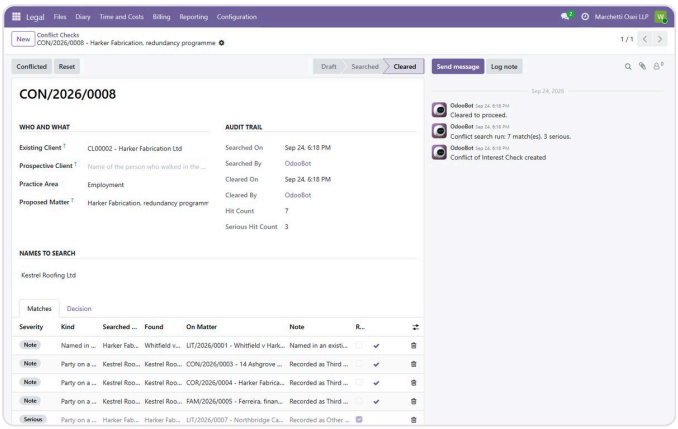
1. Open Files, then Conflict Checks, and open CON/2026/0012 (Conflicted)
2. Read the matches and the Decision tab
3. Open CON/2026/0008: three serious matches, each reviewed, then cleared



1

The checks

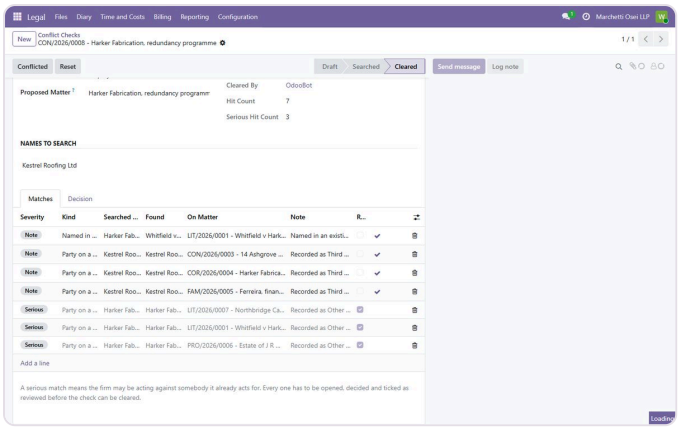
Files, then Conflict Checks. Each line shows the proposed matter, the client or prospect, when it was searched, how many matches and how many serious. Conflicted checks are red, checks with serious matches still waiting are amber, cleared ones are green.



2

Raise the check

Press New. Pick the **existing client** or type the **prospective client**'s name (one or the other is required), the practice area and a one-line **proposed matter**. Under **Names to Search** put every name on the other side, one per line: the opponent, their directors, their insurer, anyone with an interest. Lines of two letters or fewer are ignored.



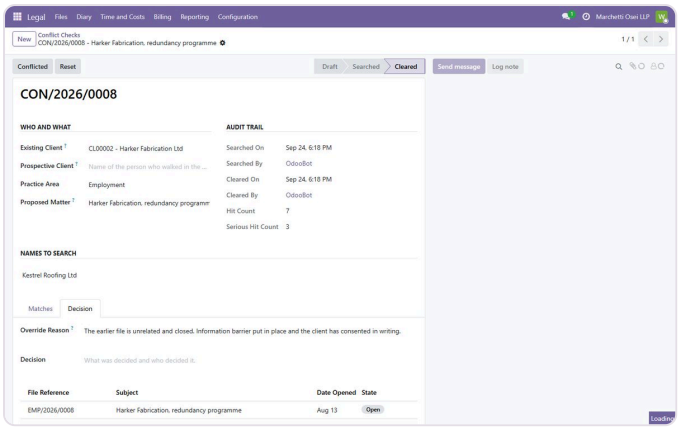
3

Run the search

Press **Run the Search**. The client's own name and every other-side name are searched against clients, parties on files and matter names and numbers, across the whole practice whatever the searcher's own rights. A pop-up says how many matches were found and the audit trail records who searched and when. Running it again replaces the earlier matches.

How a match is graded

MATCH	GRADE	WHY
An other-side name is an existing client	Serious	The firm would be acting against its own client.
Our client's name is recorded as the other side on a file	Serious	The firm is already acting against this person.
Our client's name is another existing client	Look At It	Probably the same person, possibly a duplicate record.
A name appears as a non-adverse party on a file	Note	Worth knowing, rarely a conflict.
A name appears in a matter's title or number	Note	Named on an existing file.

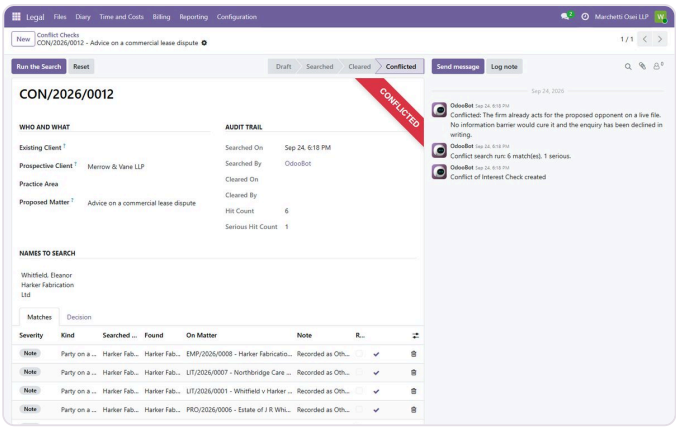


4

Decide and clear

Open each serious match, decide, and tick it reviewed with the check button on its line. If any serious match was found, write the **Override Reason** on the Decision tab: an information barrier, informed consent in writing, an old and unrelated file. Then press **Clear to Proceed**. It refuses while a serious match is unreviewed or the reason is empty, and stamps who cleared it and when.

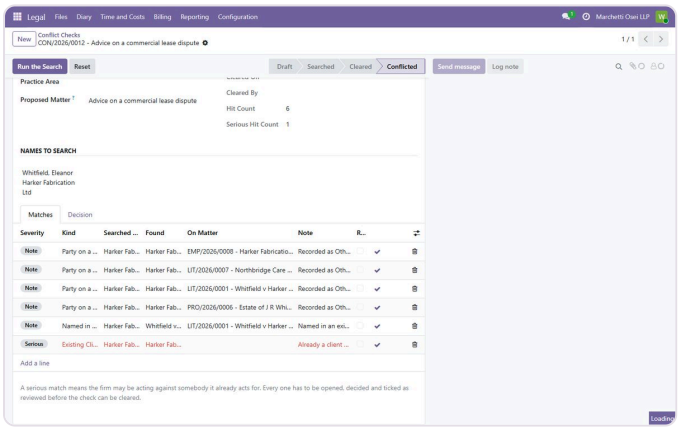
The Decision tab also lists every matter opened against the check.



5

Or mark it conflicted

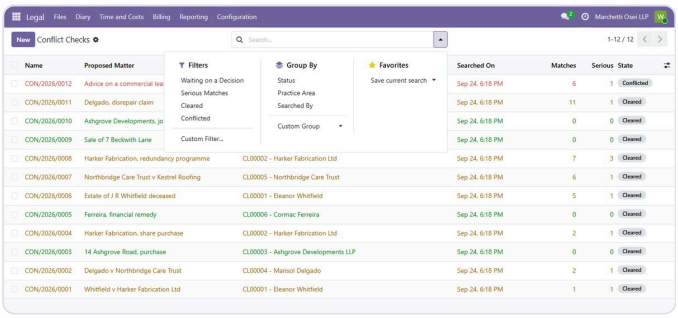
If the firm cannot act, write the **Decision** and press **Conflicted**. The check turns red with a ribbon and cannot be used to open a file. A decision note is required, so the next person who takes the same call can find the reason.



6

The matches on a conflicted check

Here one of the names on the other side, Eleanor Whitfield, is already a client of the firm: one serious match, and the firm declined the work.



7

Reset, and the filters

Reset puts a check back to draft so names can be added, unless a matter has already been opened against it, in which case raise a new check. A cleared check cannot be searched again. Filters: Waiting on a Decision, Serious Matches, Cleared, Conflicted.

PART 7 Opening and running a matter

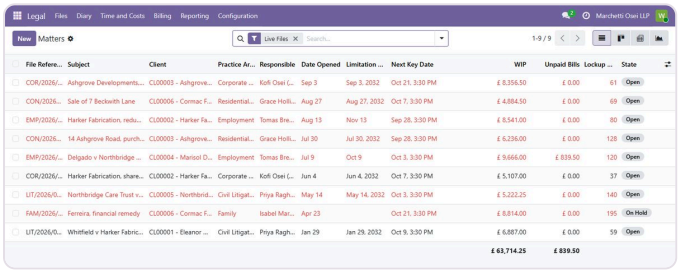
The matter is the file. It starts as an enquiry, opens once the checks are done, can be put on hold, and closes only when every penny is settled. Everything else in the system hangs off it.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Every field on the matter and what it drives
- The five checks the Open the File button makes
- Parties, key dates, time, disbursements, bills, documents and client money tabs
- Hold, resume, close, reopen and file destroyed, and what each one refuses
- The money panel: WIP, realisation, lock-up and the fee cap

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

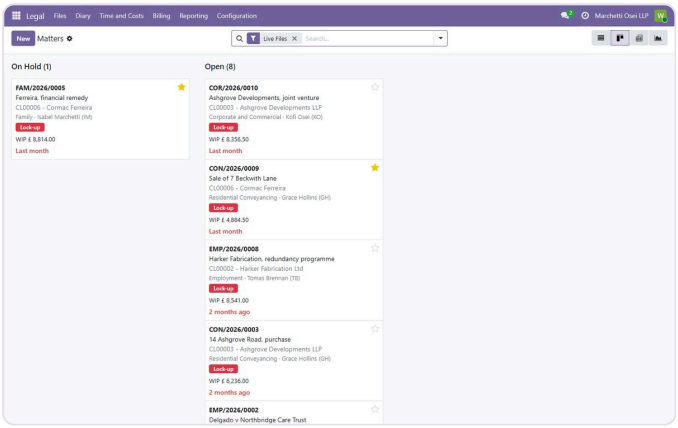
1. Open Files, then Matters, then LIT/2026/0011 (an Enquiry)
2. Open LIT/2026/0001 and walk the tabs from Parties to Notes
3. Open FAM/2026/0005 (on hold) and PRO/2026/0006 (closed)



1

The matters list

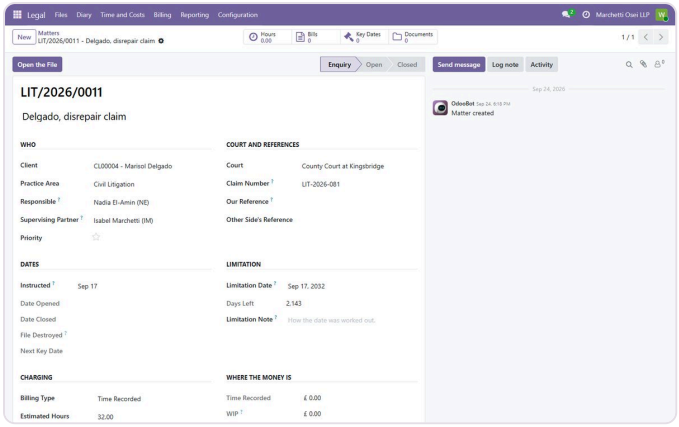
Files, then Matters, opening on Live Files. Number, title, client, practice area, fee earner, opened, limitation, next key date, WIP, owed, lock-up days and status. Red means over the lock-up target or over the fee cap, amber means on hold, grey means closed.



2

The board

The same files as cards by status, with Lock-up and Over cap badges, WIP and the days to the next key date. Matters also open in pivot and graph views.



3

Start the enquiry

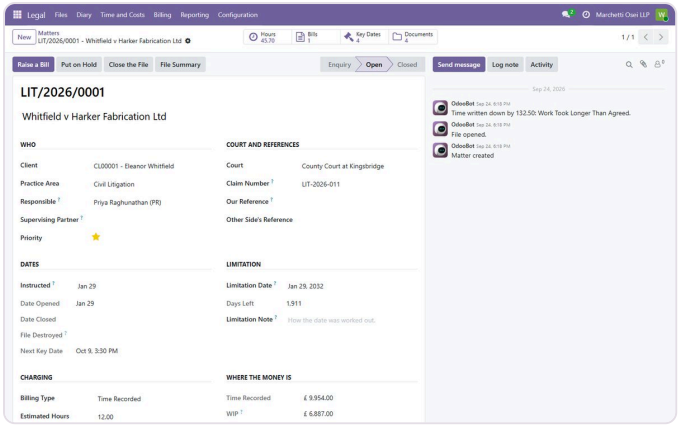
Press New. Give the **title** ("Whitfield v Harker Fabrication Ltd"), the client, practice area, responsible fee earner (proposed from the client) and supervising partner, and the priority star. The **court**, claim number, **our reference** (proposed from the fee earner's initials) and **their reference** go under Court and References. Link the cleared **conflict check** at the bottom. The file is numbered on save from the practice area code.

A fee earner cannot supervise their own file.

What Open the File checks

CHECK	REFUSED WITH
A cleared conflict check is linked (if the setting is on)	No cleared conflict check. Run the search, review, clear.
The client's identity is verified (if the setting is on)	The firm has not verified who the client is.
The engagement letter date is on the client (same setting)	No signed engagement letter, so no agreed basis for charging.
A contentious practice area has a court on the file	Put the court on the file before opening it.
The date instructed is filled in	Limitation is counted from it.

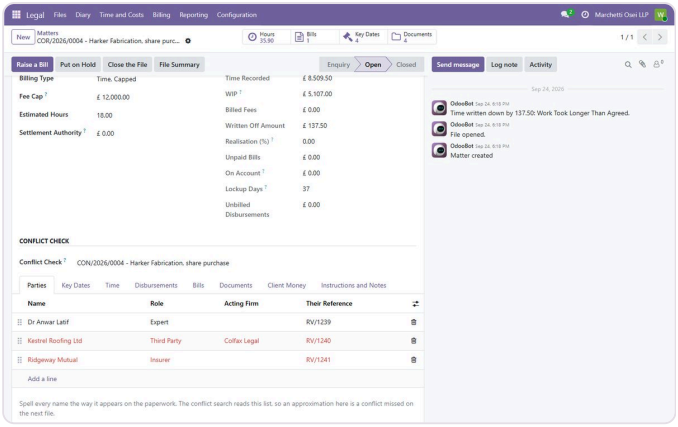
When all five pass the file moves to **Open**, the opened date is stamped, a Prospect client becomes Active, and "File opened" is posted in the chatter. The opened date cannot be earlier than the date instructed.



4

The open file

The header now offers Raise a Bill, Put on Hold, Close the File and File Summary. The buttons at the top right open the hours, the bills, and count the key dates and documents.



5

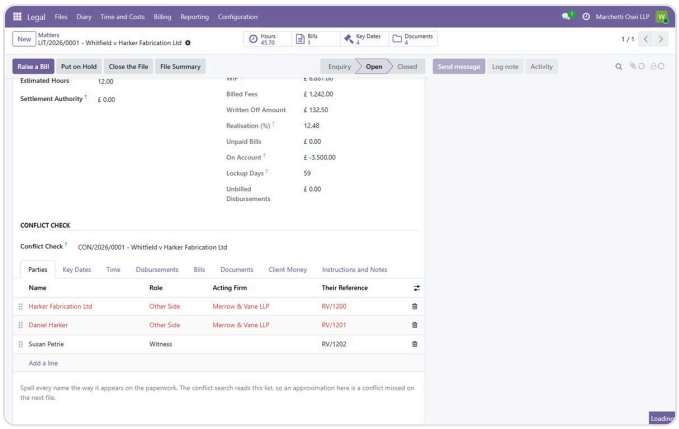
Dates, limitation, charging and money

Dates: instructed, opened, closed, destroyed and the next key date. **Limitation**: the date is proposed from the date instructed plus the practice area's period, can be corrected by the fee earner, shows the days left, and has a note for how it was worked out. **Charging**: time recorded, fixed fee, time capped, monthly retainer or conditional fee, the fixed fee or cap, estimated hours and, for partners only, settlement authority.

A fixed fee file needs its figure and a capped file needs its cap. A limitation date earlier than the date instructed is refused.

Where the money is

FIGURE	HOW IT IS WORKED OUT
Hours and Recorded	All recorded, billed and written-off time, in hours and value.
WIP	Recorded chargeable time still to bill, plus recorded unbilled disbursements.
Billed Fees	The fees on every delivered or paid bill.
Written Off	Every write-off and write-down on the file's time.
Realisation	Billed fees as a percentage of recorded value.
Owed	Delivered bills not yet paid, less client money already applied.
Client Money	The posted client ledger entries attributed to this file.
Lock-up	Days since the oldest unbilled time, plus days since the oldest unpaid bill. Over the target turns the file red.
Over the Cap	Billed fees plus unbilled time above the agreed cap shows a red ribbon.

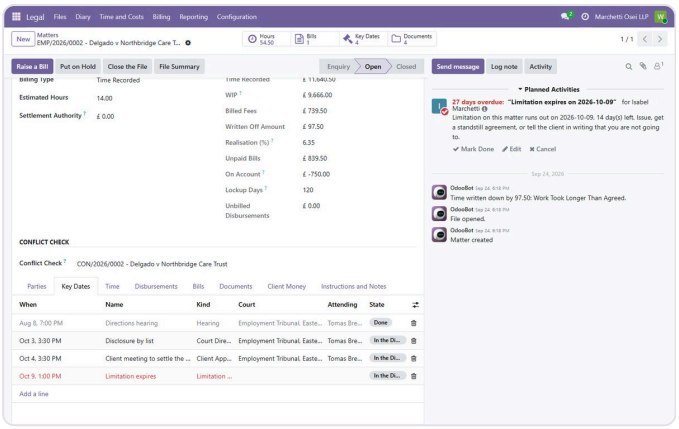


6

Parties

Every other person on the file: name, role (other side, co-claimant, co-defendant, third party, insurer, witness, expert, counsel, solicitor on the other side, other), the contact, the firm acting for them and their reference, email, phone and a note. Other side, co-defendant, third party and insurer count as adverse and show in red; the conflict search treats them that way. The same name twice on one file is refused.

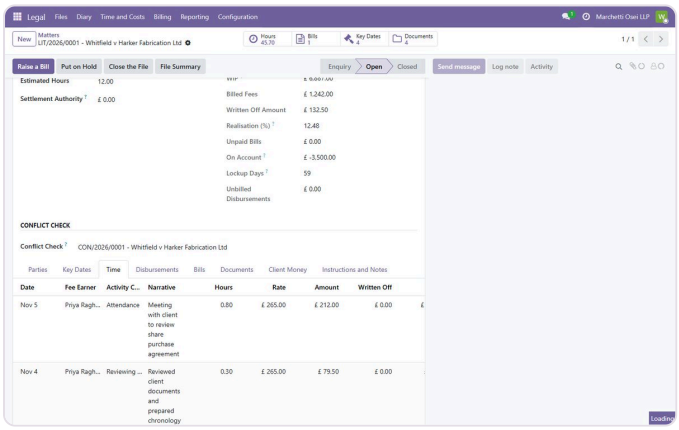
Spell names exactly as on the paperwork. The next conflict search reads this list.



7

Key Dates

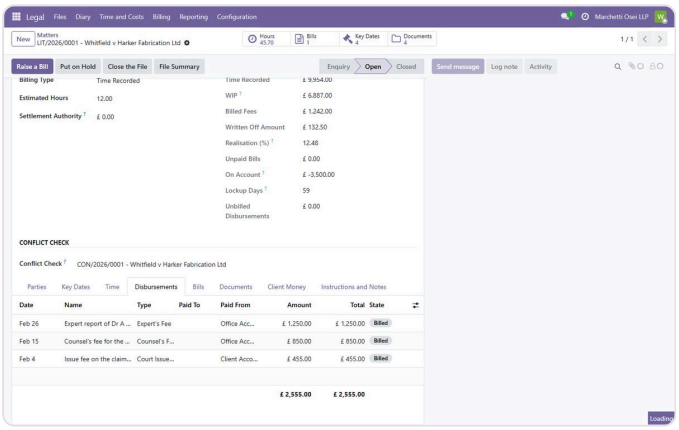
The file's diary, limitation in red, done and vacated entries greyed. Part 8 covers it in full.



8

Time

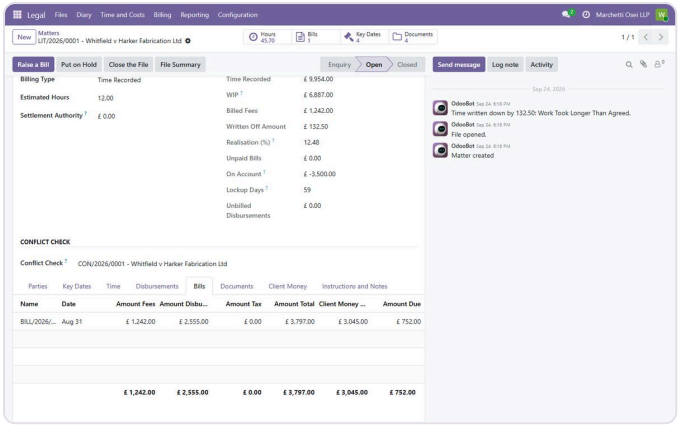
Every time entry on the file with hours, rate, recorded value, written off and to bill. Read only here: time is entered under Time Recording (Part 10).



9

Disbursements

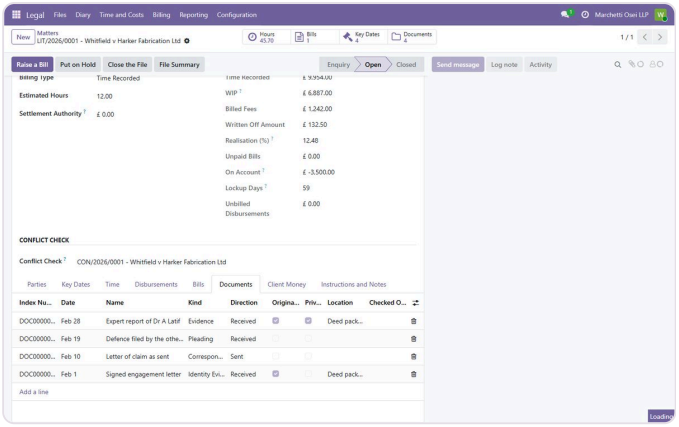
Money laid out on the file, its type, who was paid, office or client account, net, tax, total and status (Part 11).



10

Bills

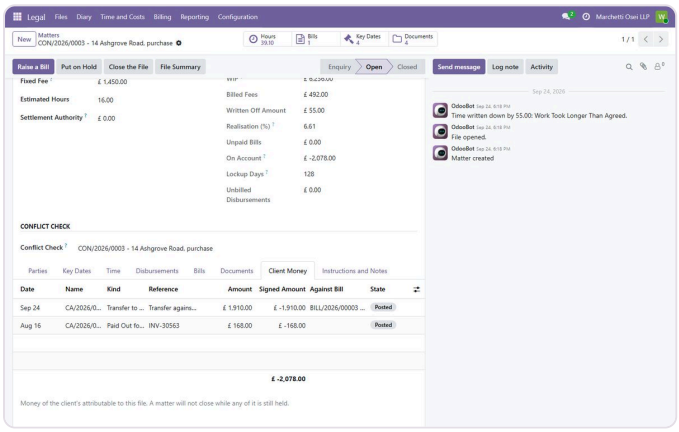
Every bill on the file with fees, disbursements, tax, total, the amount taken from client account and what is still due (Part 13).



11

Documents

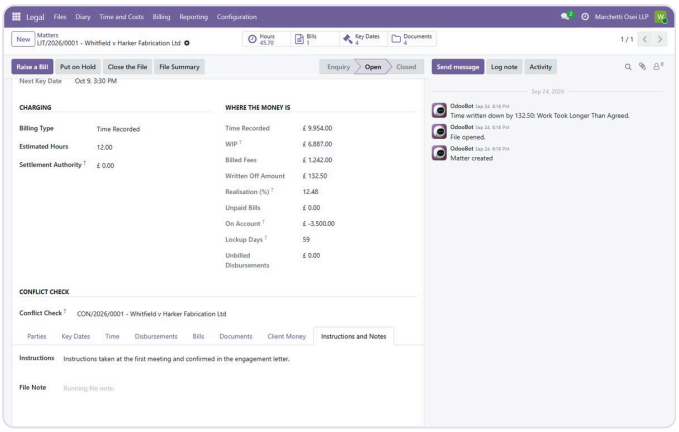
The file index, editable in place: reference, date, title, kind, sent or received, whether it is an original, privileged, where it is kept and who has it (Part 9).



12

Client Money

The client ledger entries attributed to this file. A file will not close while any of this money is still held.

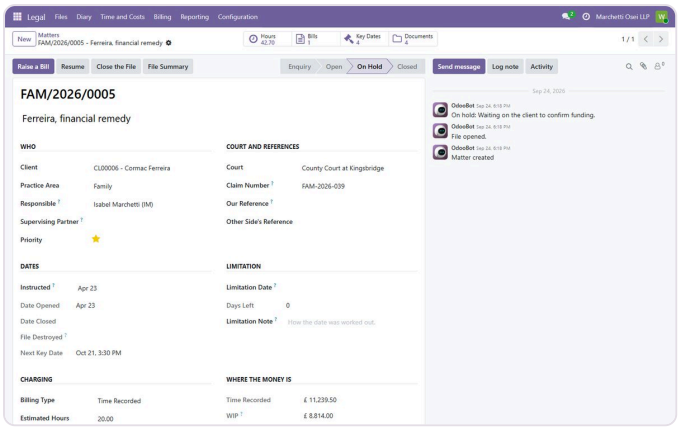


13

Instructions and Notes

What the client asked the firm to do, and a running file note. The chatter below keeps every status change, activity and email.

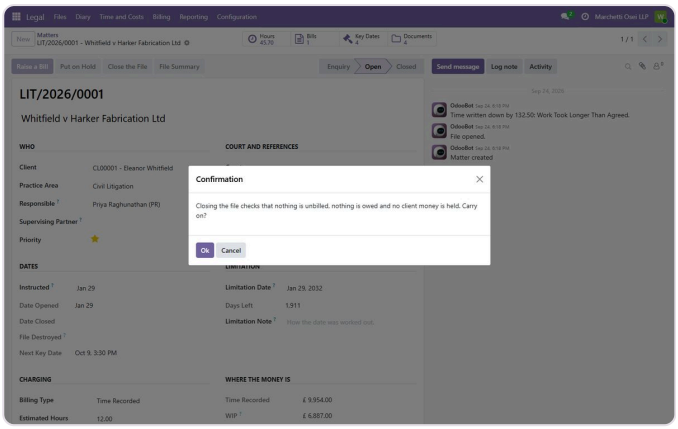
Hold, close, reopen, destroy



14

Put on hold and resume

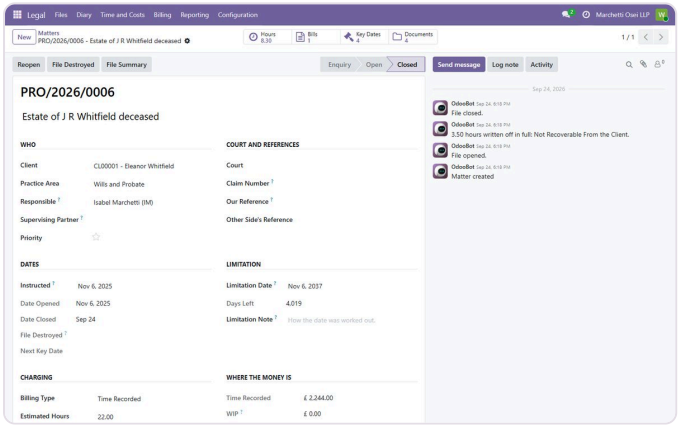
Put on Hold refuses until a **hold reason** is recorded on the file, because a file with no reason on it is a file nobody picks back up. The reason goes into the chatter and shows in the Conflict Check block while the file is on hold. **Resume** puts the file back to Open and clears the reason. Time can still be recorded on a file on hold.



15

Close the file

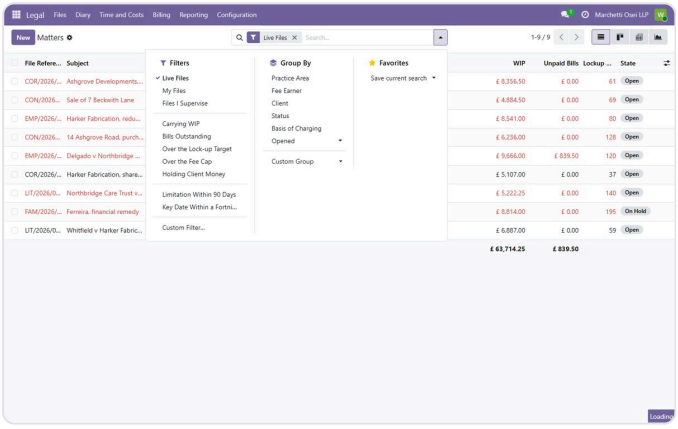
Close the File asks for confirmation, then refuses while there is any WIP, any unpaid bill, any client money held, or any key date still planned or confirmed. Each refusal says what is left and how much. An enquiry that never opened is deleted, not closed.



16

Closed, reopened, destroyed

A closed file stamps the closed date and takes no more time or disbursements. **Reopen** puts it back to Open. **File Destroyed** records the date the paper file was destroyed under the firm's retention policy, and is only offered on a closed file.



17

Filters a partner uses

Live Files, My Files, Files I Supervise, Carrying WIP, Bills Outstanding, Over the Lock-up Target, Over the Fee Cap, Holding Client Money, Limitation Within 90 Days and Key Date Within a Fortnight. Group by practice area, fee earner, client, status, basis of charging or month opened.

> The status of a file, a bill, a time entry, a disbursement and a client ledger entry is moved only by its buttons. Typing a new status in directly, by import or by any other route, is refused, so no check can be walked round.

PART 8 The diary and the limitation date

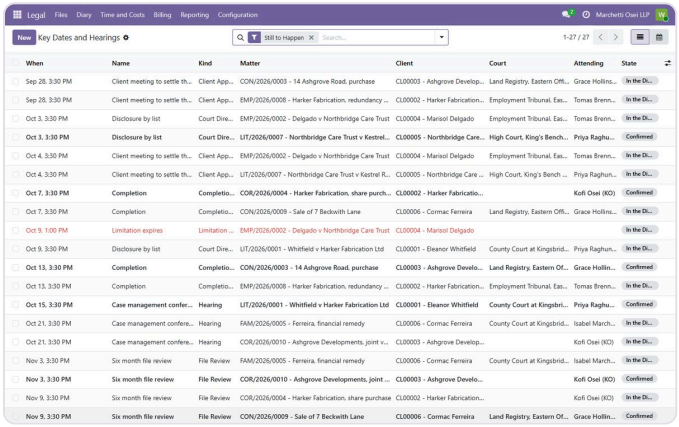
Hearings, filing deadlines, court directions, client appointments, file reviews and completions all go in one diary. The limitation date is a diary entry too, with rules no other entry has.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- The seven kinds of key date and the five states
- Confirm, Done, Adjourned and Vacate, and the outcome they need
- The limitation entry: one per file, never vacated, never deleted
- The warning activity and the client reminder email

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

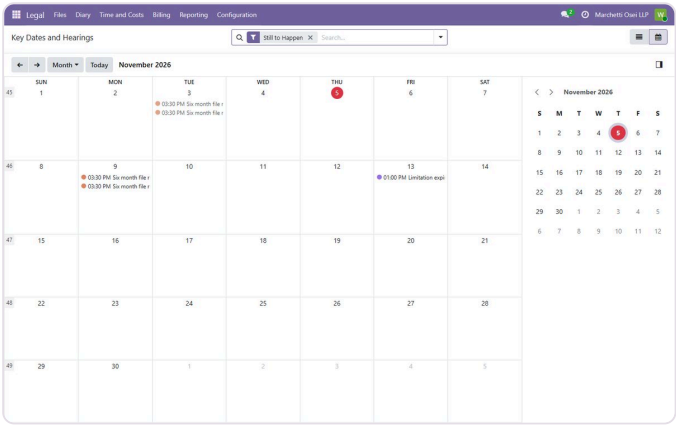
1. Open Diary, then Key Dates and Hearings, and switch to the calendar
2. Open a case management conference and read the outcome box
3. Open Diary, then Limitation Dates: every live one in the practice



1

Key Dates and Hearings

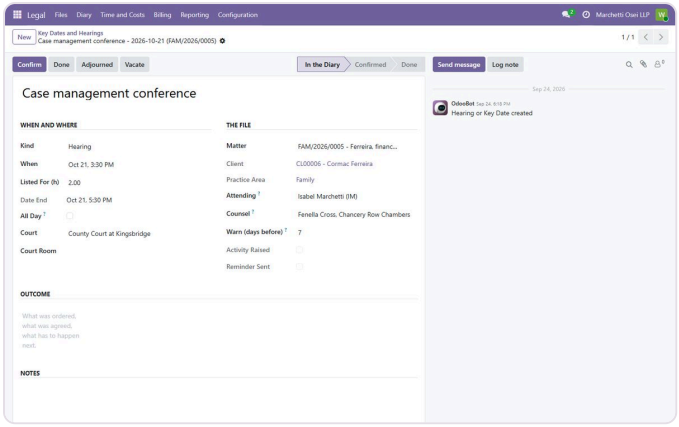
Diary, then Key Dates and Hearings, opening on Still to Happen. Date, entry, kind, matter, client, court, attending fee earner and state. Limitation dates are red, confirmed entries bold, done and vacated ones grey.



2

The calendar

The same diary by month, coloured by kind. Entries are added from the list or the file, not by clicking the calendar.

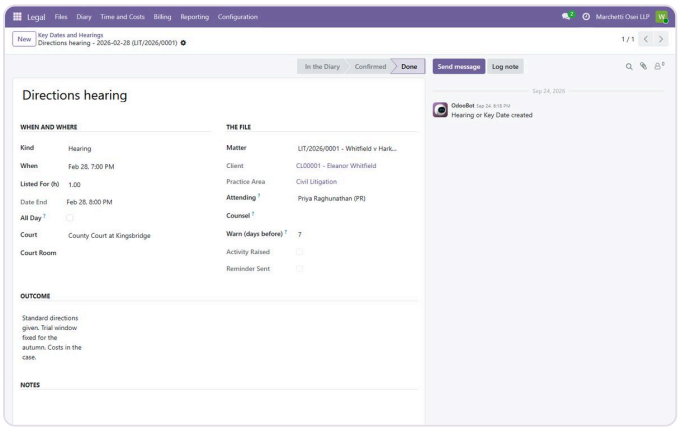


3

Add a key date

Give the entry a title and pick its **kind**: hearing, limitation date, filing deadline, court direction, client appointment, file review or completion date. Set the start, the duration in hours (the end is worked out) or all day, the court and room. Picking the matter fills in the fee earner and the court. Add counsel if instructed.

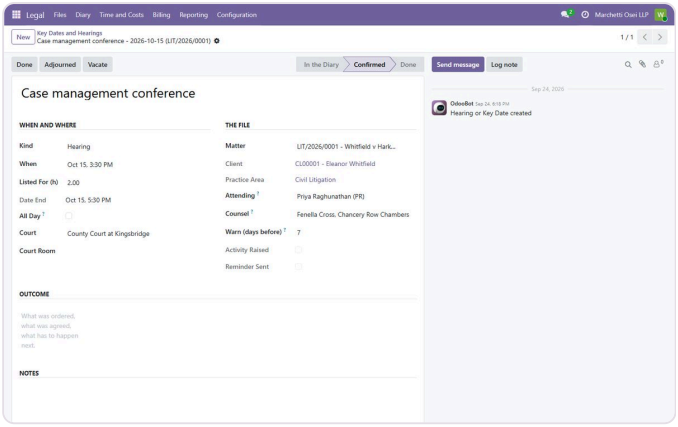
Warn (days before) defaults to 7 for an ordinary entry and to the Limitation Warnings setting for a limitation date. One entry may not run over 24 hours.



5

Done or adjourned

Done and **Adjourned** both refuse until the **Outcome** is written: what was ordered, what was agreed, what happens next, or why it was adjourned and to when. **Vacate** takes an entry out of the diary.

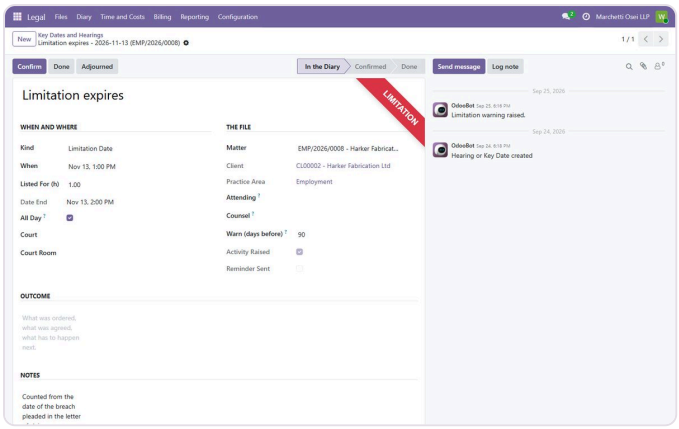


4

Confirm

A new entry is In the Diary. **Confirm** once the court or the other side has confirmed it. An adjourned entry can be confirmed again on its new date.

The limitation date

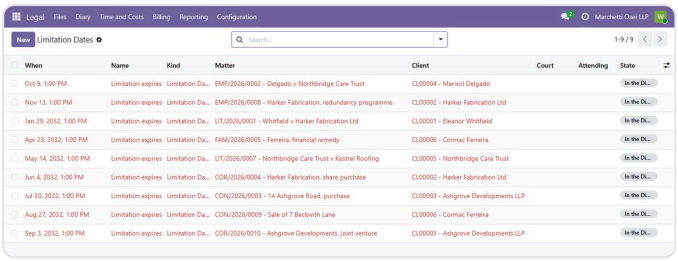


6

One per file, and it cannot go

Add it from the file's Key Dates tab with kind Limitation Date, on the date shown in the file's Limitation block. A red ribbon marks it. A second live limitation entry on the same file is refused, the Vacate button is hidden and refused, and a live one cannot be deleted. If the claim has been issued, mark it Done with a note saying so.

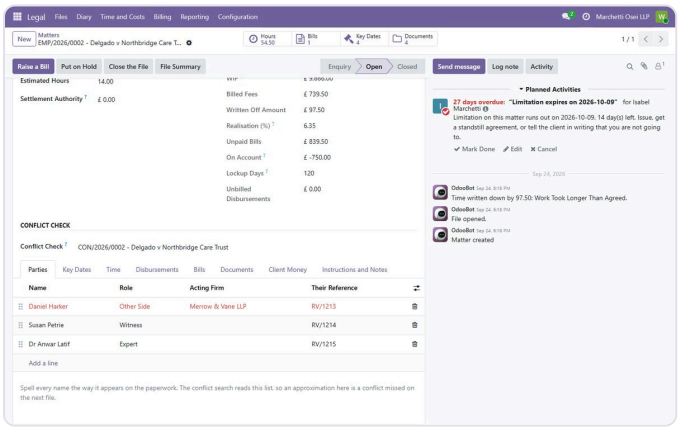
The file's limitation date is a proposal on the matter. The warning job reads the diary entry, so a file with no limitation entry in the diary gets no warning. Add it when the file opens.



7

Limitation Dates

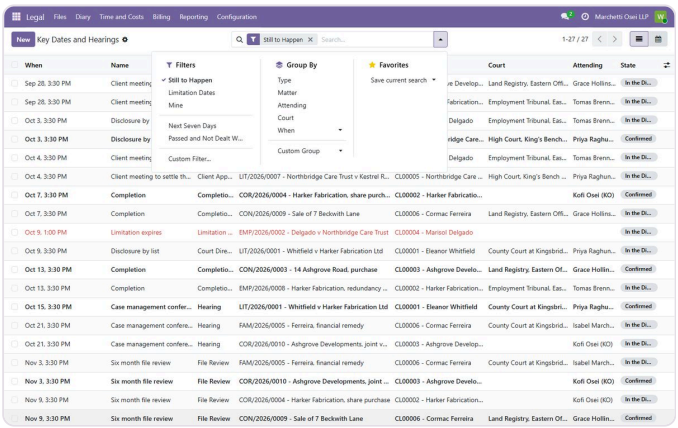
Diary, then Limitation Dates: every live limitation entry in the practice. A partner should be able to read this page in a minute.



8

The warning

Every day a job looks at live limitation entries. Once one is inside its warning period it raises a To Do activity on the file for the attending fee earner (or the file's fee earner, or the supervisor), due on the limitation date, saying how many days are left and what to do: issue, agree a standstill, or tell the client in writing. It posts "Limitation warning raised" and does it only once per entry.



9

Filters and the client reminder

Still to Happen, Limitation Dates, Mine, Next Seven Days and Passed and Not Dealt With, grouped by type, matter, attending, court or date. A second daily job emails the client about a hearing, completion or appointment once it is inside its warning days, using the Hearing Reminder template, once per entry, and only if the client has an email address.

PART 9 The document register

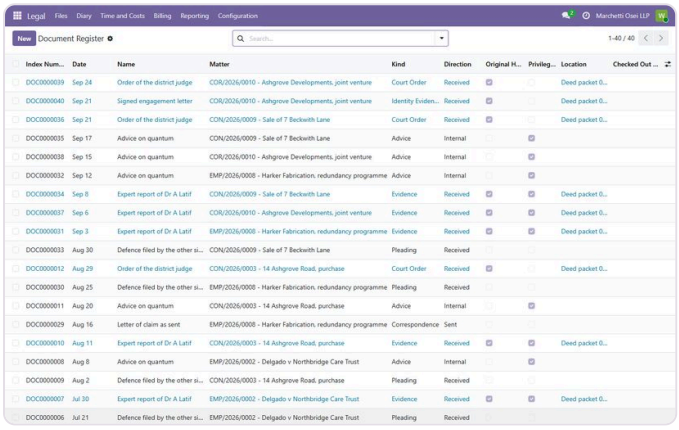
An index of what is on each file: what it is, when it came in or went out, whether it is privileged, and, for originals, where it physically is and who has it. Originals are the ones that go missing.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Indexing a document and attaching the scan
- Originals, privilege and the physical location
- Signing an original out and back in

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

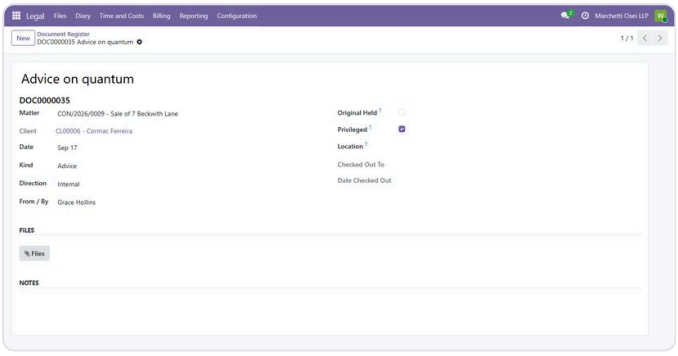
1. Open Files, then Document Register, and filter Originals Held
2. Open a signed engagement letter and look at its header button



1

The register

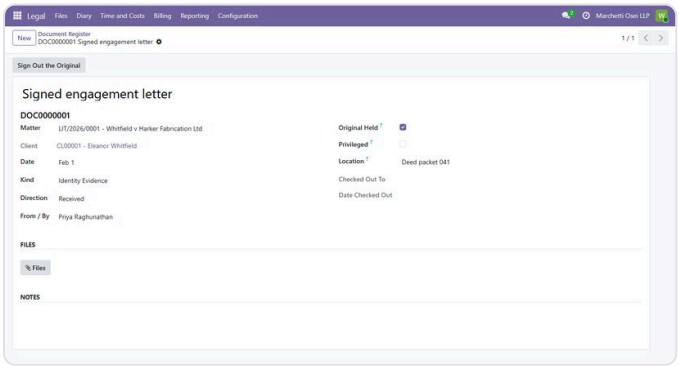
Files, then Document Register, or the Documents tab on a file. Reference (DOC0000001 on), date, title, matter, kind, direction, original, privileged, location and who has it. Originals show in blue, signed-out documents in amber.



2

Index a document

Title, matter, date (never in the future), **kind** (correspondence, pleading, contract or deed, evidence, advice, identity evidence, court order, bill or fee note, other), **direction** (received, sent, internal) and the author. Tick **Privileged** for advice and expert material. Attach the scan or file under Files.



3

Originals: sign out and back

Tick **Original** and say where it is kept. **Sign Out the Original** records the signed-in user and today's date against it. **Back on the File** clears both. A copy cannot be signed out, and an original already out cannot be signed out twice.

Filters: Originals Held, Signed Out and Privileged, grouped by matter, type or date.

PART 10 Recording time

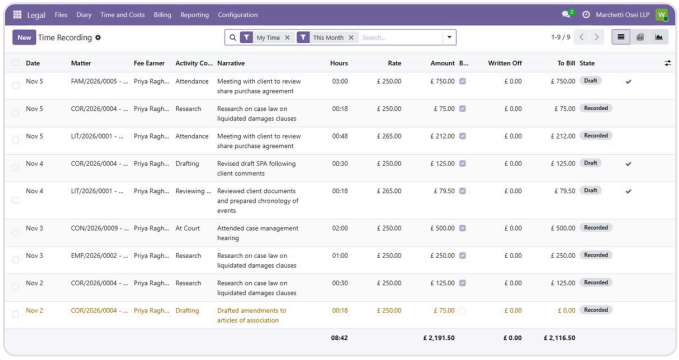
Time is what the firm sells. An entry belongs to one file and one fee earner, is priced off the rate card for the day the work was done, and carries a narrative the client will read on the bill.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- The timer, and rounding up to the charging unit
- Typing time in, the activity codes and the narrative rule
- Non-billable time and its reasons
- Recording, writing down and writing off, and the partner's limit
- What happens to an entry once it is on a bill

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

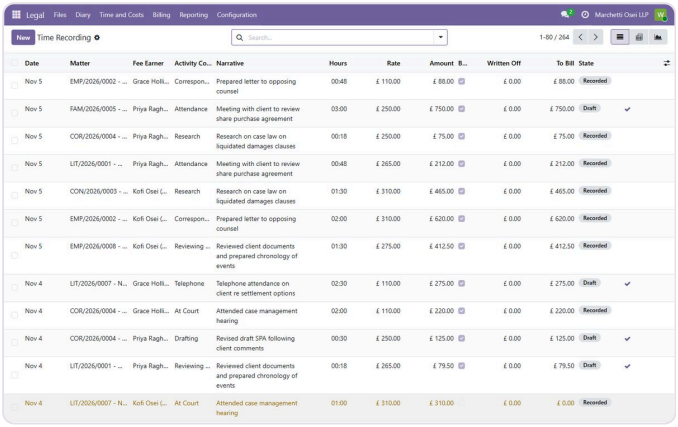
1. Open Time and Costs, then Time Recording (it opens on My Time this month)
2. Open a Recorded entry and read the rate, value and To Bill
3. Open the written-down entry and the written-off entry and compare



1

My time this month

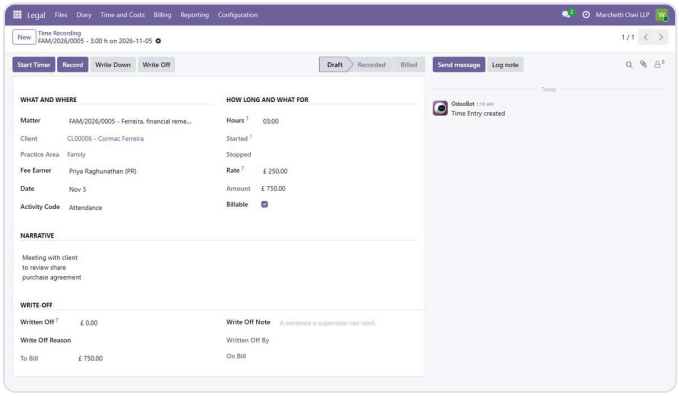
Time and Costs, then Time Recording. It opens on **My Time** and **This Month**. The list is editable in place, so a day's time can be typed straight in, and the tick on a draft line records it. A running timer shows blue, non-billable time amber, written-off time grey.



2

The whole practice

Take the filters off to see every entry you are allowed to see, with hours, recorded value, written off and to bill totalled at the foot.



3

A new entry

Pick the **matter**; the client and practice area follow. The **fee earner** defaults to you and the **date** to today (a future date is refused). Pick the **activity**: attendance, drafting, research, telephone, correspondence, reviewing documents, at court, travel and waiting, negotiation or file administration. The **rate** is filled from the rate card (Part 4) and can be overtyped.

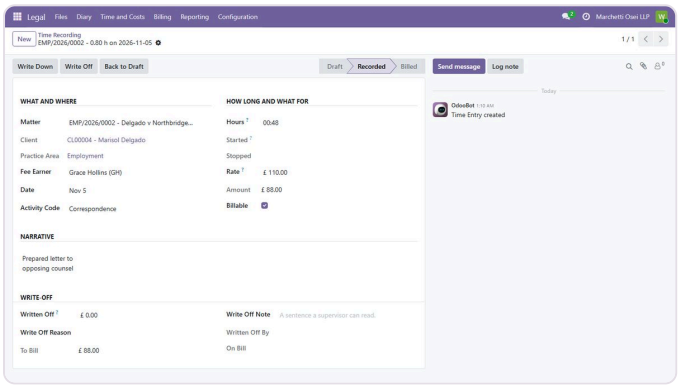
The timer

On a draft entry press **Start Timer**. The start time is stamped and a blue Timer Running ribbon shows. A fee earner can only have one timer running, so the same minutes are never charged twice. **Stop Timer** works out the elapsed time and rounds it up to the next charging unit, never less than one unit: a five minute call is one six minute unit, exactly thirty minutes is five units. Or skip the timer and type the hours in.

> A timer left running for more than ten hours is stopped by a job that runs every four hours. The entry is capped at eight hours, kept as a draft, and a note asks the fee earner to check it before recording.

The narrative and non-billable time

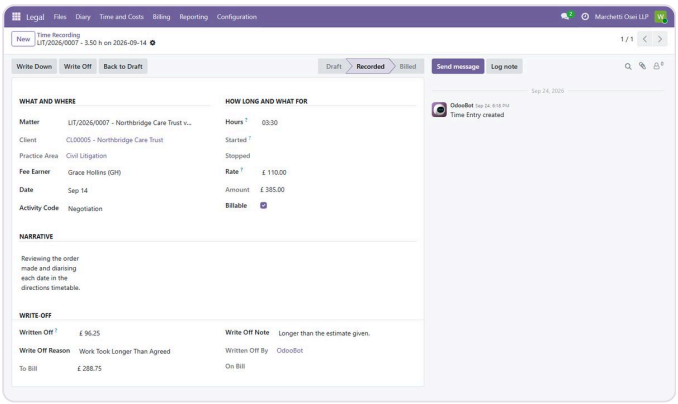
The narrative is what the client reads on the bill. On a chargeable entry it must say what was done: under twelve characters is refused once the entry is recorded. Untick **Billable** for time the firm will not charge, and pick the reason: internal work, file administration, training, dealing with a complaint, business development, or courtesy to the client. Non-billable time with no reason cannot be recorded.



4

Record it

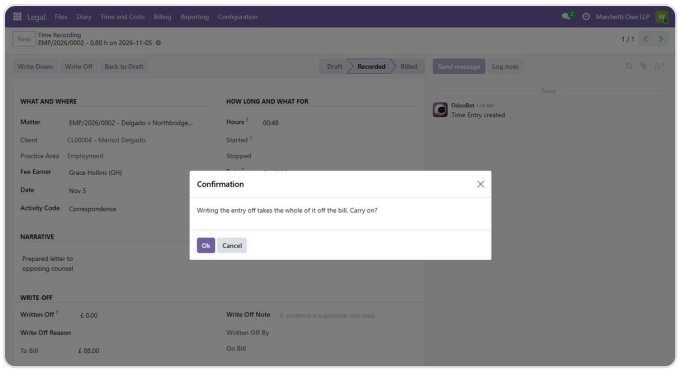
Record commits the entry. It refuses while the timer is running, with no hours, or if the file is not open or on hold. A recorded chargeable entry is **work in progress**. Time on a closed file is refused, and one entry cannot be over 24 hours.



5

Write down

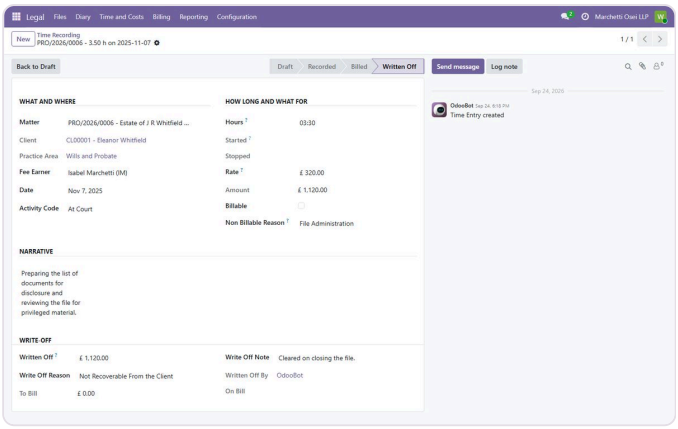
To bill less than was recorded, put the amount coming off in **Written Off**, pick a reason and add a note, then press **Write Down**. The entry keeps its full recorded value and **To Bill** drops. It must be less than the whole entry.



6

Write off

To take the whole entry off the bill, pick a reason and press **Write Off**, then confirm. The entry moves to Written Off and its full value is recorded as written off. Both write-downs and write-offs post a line in the file's chatter.

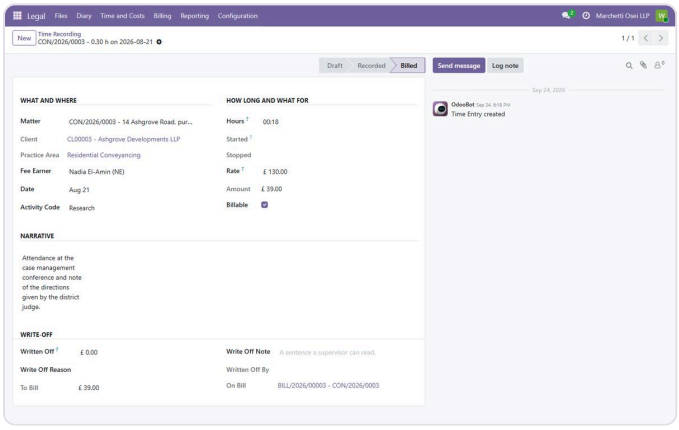


7

A written-off entry

Reasons: work took longer than agreed, over the agreed cap, client goodwill, trainee learning time, duplicated work, our error, not recoverable from the client, other. The user who did it is stamped in Written Off By.

Above the Write-off Limit only a Supervising Partner may write off or down. The limit is checked on the buttons and on the field itself, so typing a figure into the list does not get round it.

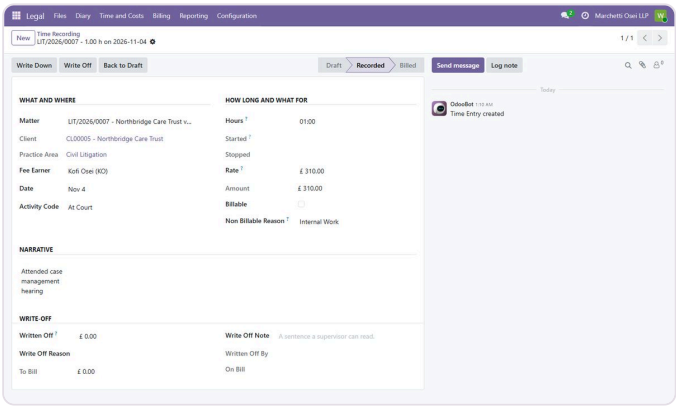


8

Once it is billed

When a bill is approved its time moves to **Billed** and shows the bill it is on. From then on the hours, rate, matter, date, fee earner, narrative and billable tick cannot be changed, and it cannot be deleted or written off. Cancel the bill, or raise a credit note, if it really is wrong.

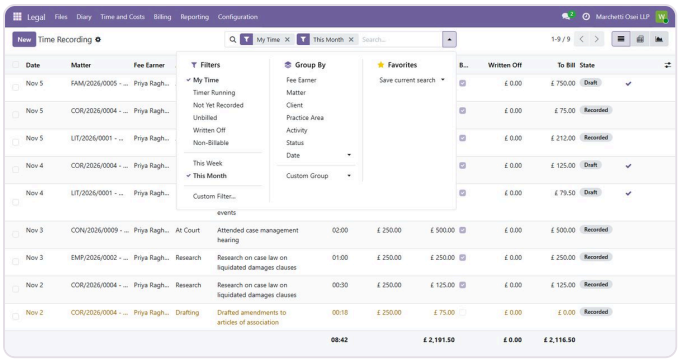
Back to Draft is offered on recorded and written-off time and lets go of any bill that was holding it.



9

A non-billable entry

Recorded with a reason, kept out of WIP and out of the fee earner's chargeable hours, but still counted in hours recorded on the file.



10

Filters

My Time, Timer Running, Not Yet Recorded, Unbilled, Written Off, Non-Billable, This Week, This Month, grouped by fee earner, matter, client, practice area, activity, status or date. Time also opens as a pivot and as a weekly hours graph.

PART 11 Disbursements

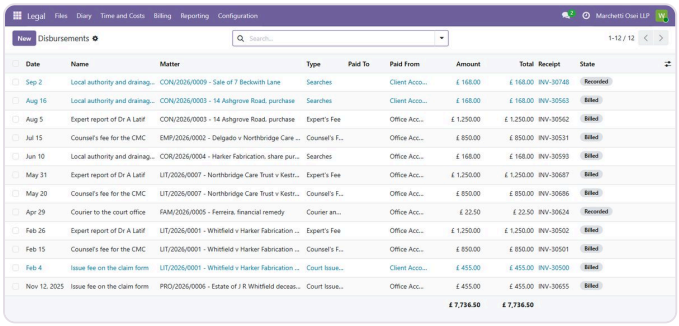
Money laid out for the client and recovered in full. It is kept apart from fees so it is never reported as turnover, never counts towards a fee cap, and is shown on its own on the bill.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Recording a disbursement from office or from client money
- What happens to the client account when client money pays it
- Writing a disbursement off and putting it back to draft

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

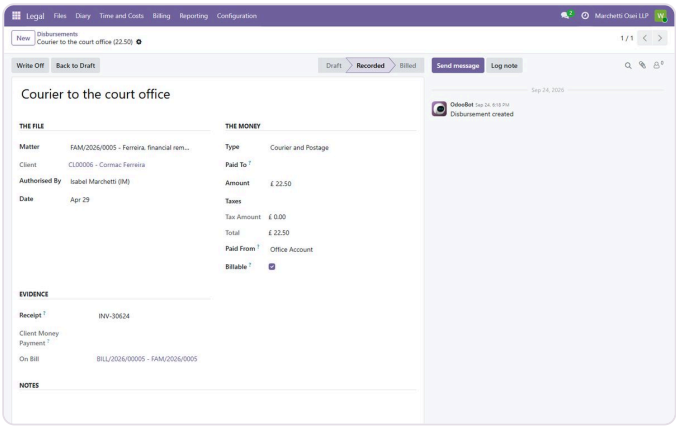
1. Open Time and Costs, then Disbursements
2. Open the searches paid from client account and look at Client Money Payment



1

The disbursements

Time and Costs, then Disbursements. Date, what it was for, matter, type, who was paid, paid from, net, tax, total, receipt and status. Paid from client account shows blue.

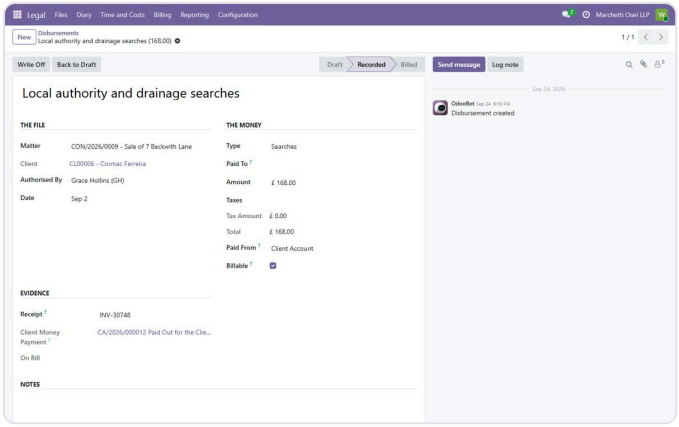


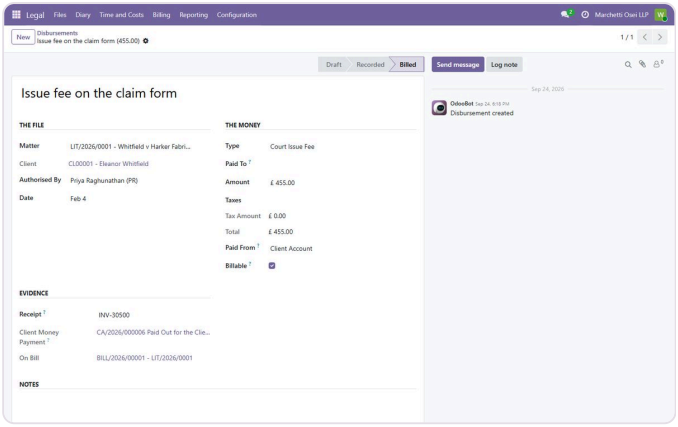
2

Record one paid from office

Describe it in the words the client will read ("Issue fee, claim form N1"), pick the matter and the **type**. The type fills in the taxes, the paid from and the default amount. Add who was paid, the amount, the receipt or invoice number, and who authorised it (you, by default). Untick Billable if the firm is standing the cost. Press **Record**.

The amount must be more than nothing and the date cannot be in the future. Nothing can be recorded on a file that is not open or on hold.





3

Paid from client account

Set **Paid From** to Client Account. On Record, a "Paid Out for the Client" entry for the total is posted to the client's ledger straight away, and shown in Client Money Payment. If the client has no open client account, or not enough on it, Record is refused and nothing moves.

Because that money has already gone, a disbursement paid from client money cannot be put back to draft. Cancel the ledger entry if it was posted in error.

4

Billed, or written off

Gathered onto a bill it shows On Bill and moves to Billed when the bill is approved. **Write Off**, with a reason, means the firm stands the cost: it becomes not billable. Filters: Unbilled, Paid From Client Account, Paid From Office and No Receipt Recorded.

PART 12 The client account

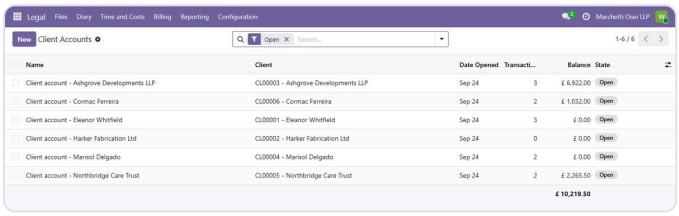
Money held for a client is not the firm's money. Each client has one ledger, kept apart from the office accounts, that can never go below nothing, and money only leaves it for the firm against a bill that has already gone out.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Opening the ledger and posting money on account
- The five kinds of entry and which way each one moves
- Every rule that stops the account going overdrawn
- Transfers to office, returning the balance and the statement

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

1. Open Billing, then Client Accounts, and open Ashgrove Developments LLP
2. Read the ledger: money in green, money out red
3. Print the statement from the header

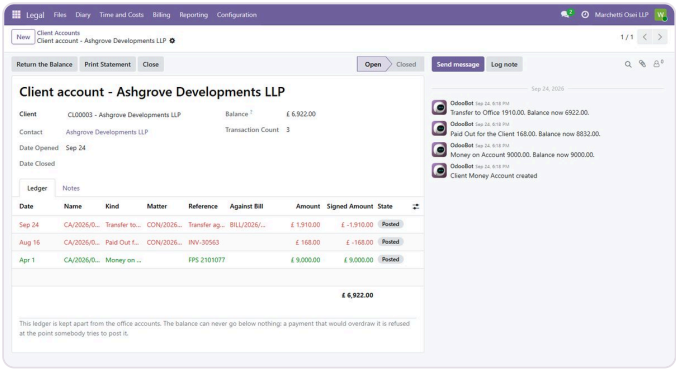


1

Client accounts

Billing, then Client Accounts, opening on Open. One account per client with its balance and number of entries; the total held for all clients is at the foot. A second open account for the same client is refused.

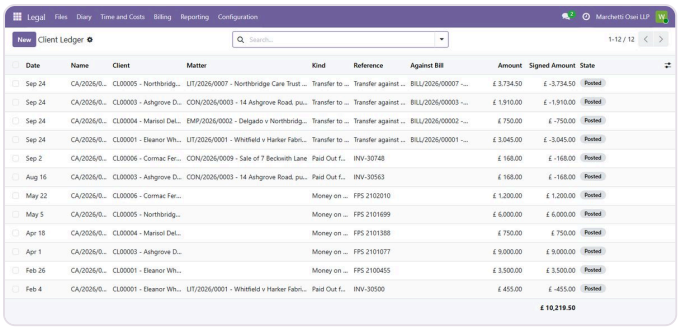
The account is created the first time someone presses On Account on the client.



2

The ledger

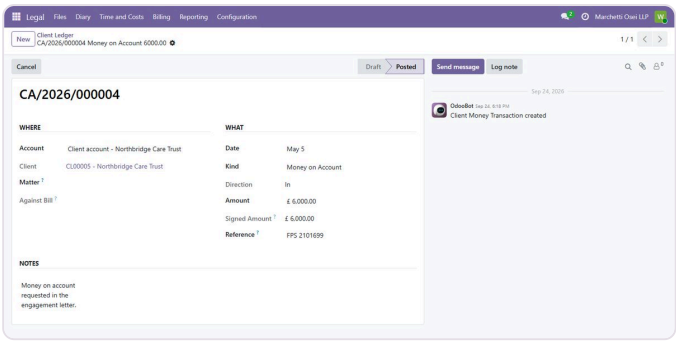
Every entry on the account: date, number, kind, matter, reference, the bill it settled, amount and the signed movement. Money in is green, money out red, unposted or cancelled grey. The balance is the sum of the posted movements.



3

The cashier's ledger

Billing, then Client Ledger (cashier and above): every entry across the practice. Filters for Not Posted, Money In, Money Out and Transfers to Office. The tick on a draft line posts it.



4

Money on account

New entry: pick the account and the matter the money relates to, the date, the **kind** and the amount, and put the bank reference or cheque number in **Reference**. Press **Post**. The new balance is written in the account's chatter.

Always pick the matter. The file's own Client Money figure counts only entries attributed to it, so money received with no matter makes the file look as if more went out than came in. The matter must belong to the same client: money cannot move between clients.

The five kinds

KIND	DIRECTION	USED FOR
Money on Account	In	Money the client sends before the work is billed.
Interest Credited	In	Interest the firm credits to the client.
Paid Out for the Client	Out	Made automatically by a disbursement paid from client account.
Transfer to Office	Out	Made by Apply Money on Account on a delivered bill (Part 13).
Returned to Client	Out	Made by Return the Balance.

What keeps it in credit

At posting

Post refuses any entry that would take the balance below nothing, and says how much the client has on account.

At cancelling

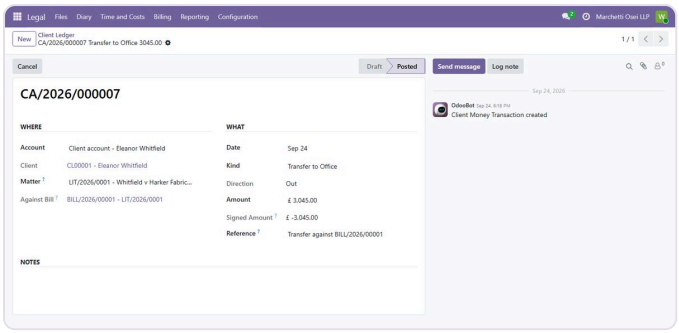
Cancelling a posted entry is refused if it would leave the account overdrawn, and an entry that settled a paid bill cannot be cancelled.

In the database

The balance is checked again whenever it changes, however the data got there: an import or a script.

Transfers

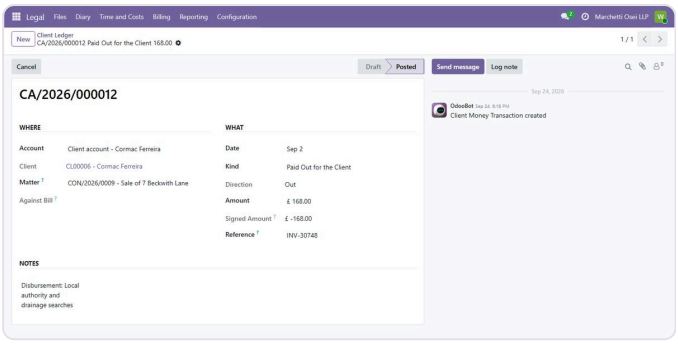
A transfer to office needs a bill that has been delivered, and the transfers against one bill can never add up to more than the bill.



5

A transfer to office

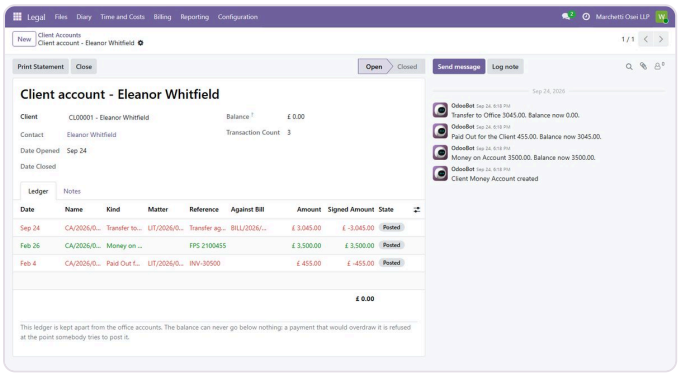
Raised by the bill, never typed by hand: it carries the bill it settled.



6

Paid out for the client

Raised by a disbursement paid from client money.



7

Return, close, reopen

Return the Balance opens a draft Returned to Client entry for everything still held; post it once the money has gone back. **Close** is refused while anything is held. **Reopen** brings a closed account back. **Print Statement** prints the ledger with the balance carried down (Part 15).

A cancelled entry can be put back to draft and posted again.

PART 13 Bills of costs

A bill gathers the unbilled work off one file, is approved, then delivered as an Odoo invoice. Fees, disbursements and tax stay apart the whole way through, and money on account is drawn down against it only once it has gone out.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

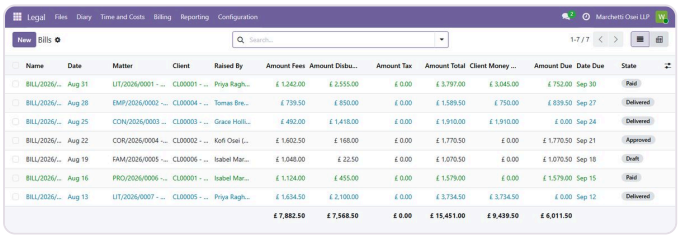
- Raising a bill and gathering work in progress for a period
- Adjustment lines, taxes and the covering narrative
- Approve: the checks, the fee cap, and what it does to the time
- Deliver and invoice, apply money on account, email, print, mark paid
- Cancelling, back to draft, and the two billing jobs

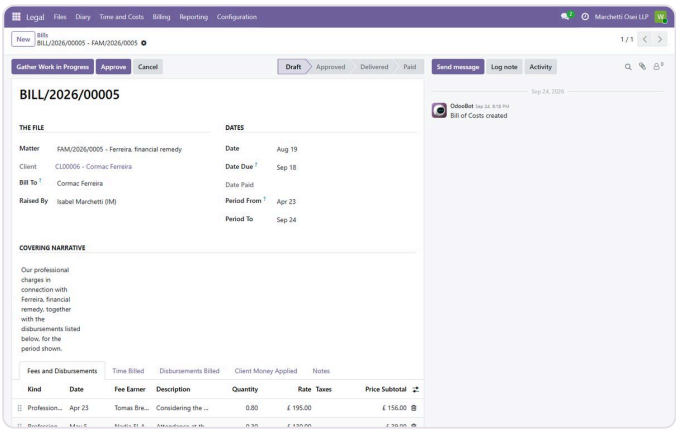
TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

1. Open Billing, then Bills, and open the four bills in Draft, Approved, Delivered and Paid
2. On the delivered bill, read the totals: fees, disbursements, tax, from client account, due
3. Open its Time Billed tab

A bill from start to paid

1 Draft — gather, adjust, narrative ▶ **2 Approved** — time and costs billed ▶ **3 Delivered** — invoice posted ▶ **4 Money on account** — transfer to office ▶ **5 Paid** — by hand or from the invoice





1

The bills

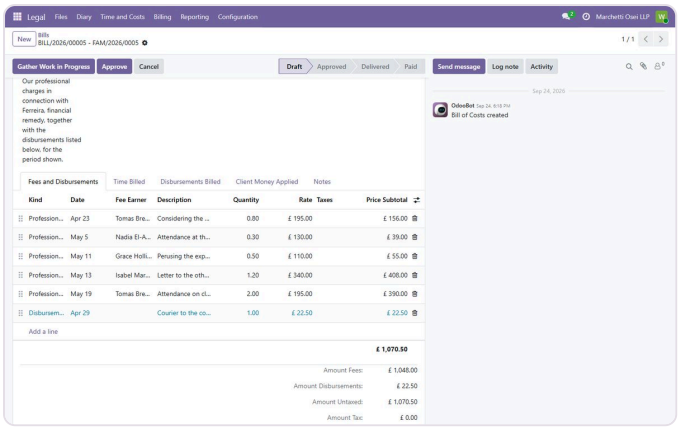
Billing, then Bills. Number, date, matter, client, raised by, fees, disbursements, tax, total, from client account, due, due date and status. Delivered bills are blue, paid green, cancelled grey. Filters: In Preparation, Delivered and Unpaid, Paid, Overdue and My Bills.

2

Raise and gather

On the file press **Raise a Bill**: a draft bill is created and the work is gathered onto it at once. Or create one under Bills, set the matter, optionally the **period** from and to, and press **Gather Work in Progress**. Every recorded, chargeable, unclaimed time entry and disbursement on the file in the period comes on as a line and is claimed, so a second bill cannot pick it up. Gathering again after changing the period lets the old lines go first; adjustment lines are kept.

Bill To is the client's Send Bills To contact, or the client. The due date cannot be before the bill date, nor the period run backwards. Nothing to gather is refused.

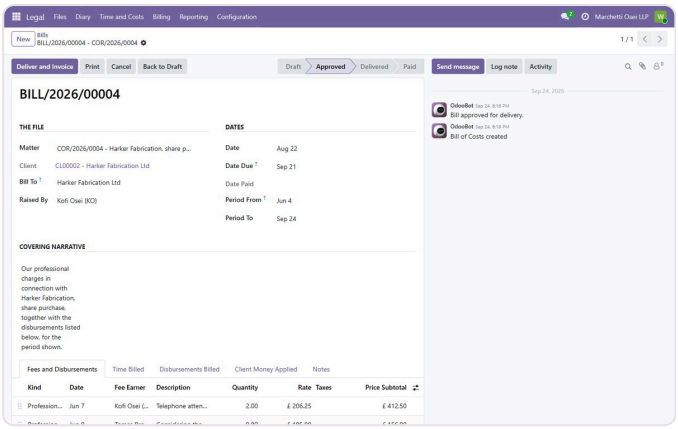


3

The lines and the narrative

Fee lines carry the date, fee earner, narrative, hours and the hourly rate after any write-down. Disbursement lines carry their type's taxes. Add VAT to fee lines in the Taxes column if the firm charges it. Add an **Adjustment** line for a discount or an agreed fixed sum; only an adjustment may be negative. Write the **Covering Narrative**: the paragraph the client reads first.

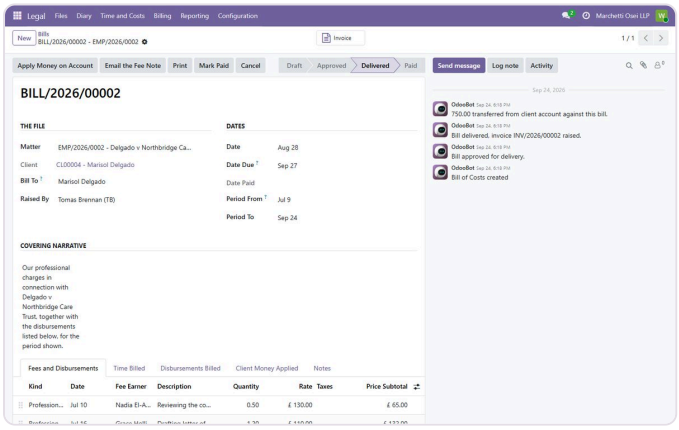
The totals under the lines show fees, disbursements, adjustments, untaxed, tax and total, then what has come from client account and what is due, with hours billed and what was written off.



4

Approve

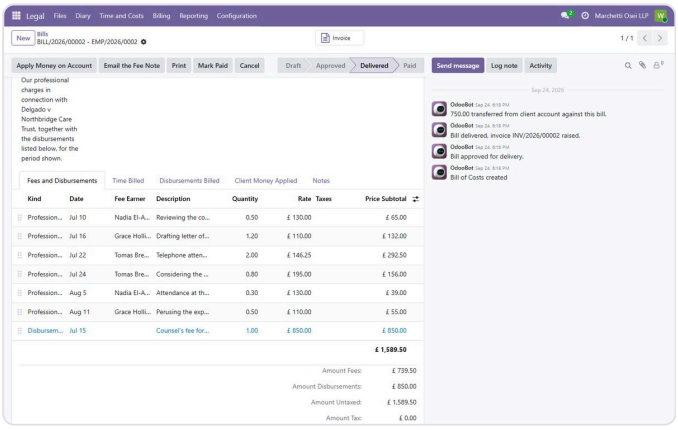
Approve refuses an empty bill, a bill that comes to nothing, a bill with no narrative, and, on a capped file, a bill that takes fees past the cap, saying by how much. On approval the time and disbursements on it move to Billed and the lines are locked. **Back to Draft** releases them again.



5

Deliver and invoice

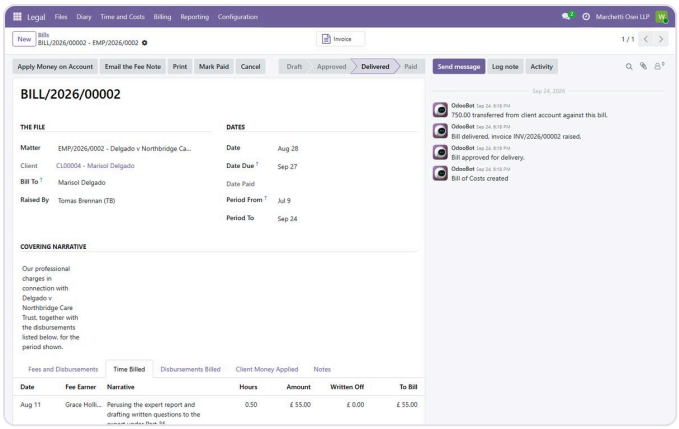
Deliver and Invoice creates and posts an Odoo customer invoice: one line per bill line, fees to the practice area's income account, disbursements to their type's recovery account, the bill date, due date, the client's payment terms, the billing journal and the file reference. The bill becomes Delivered and the **Invoice** button opens it. A billing journal in another currency is refused.



6

Apply money on account

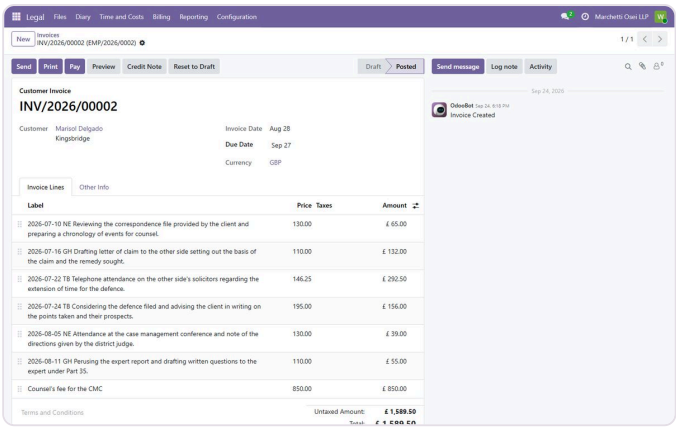
On a delivered bill the cashier or a partner presses **Apply Money on Account**. The smaller of the client's balance and what is due is posted as a Transfer to Office against this bill, and appears under From Client Account. Nothing on account, or no client account, is refused.



7

What is on the bill

Time Billed, Disbursements Billed and Client Money Applied list exactly what the bill took, with recorded, written off and billed amounts.

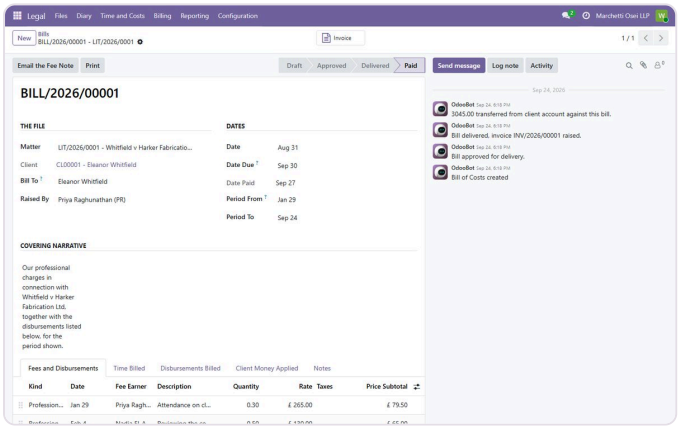


8

The invoice in Accounting

The invoice is an ordinary Odoo invoice. Register the client's payment on it as usual.

Money applied from client account is recorded on the client ledger and on the bill. Settle the invoice for that part in Accounting in the way your bookkeeper prefers, so the invoice shows paid.



9

Paid

Every night a job marks a delivered bill Paid once its invoice is paid or in payment, using the date the money actually arrived. **Mark Paid** does it by hand. **Email the Fee Note** sends the Fee Note template to Bill To (who must have an email address), and **Print** prints the bill of costs.

Cancelling and overdue bills

Cancel is refused once a bill is paid, once its invoice is posted (raise a credit note instead) and once client money has been transferred against it. Cancelling hands the time and disbursements back to work in progress. A cancelled bill can go back to draft only if none of its work has since been billed or changed. Every day a job raises a To Do activity for the fee earner on each delivered bill past its due date, once.

PART 14 Reporting

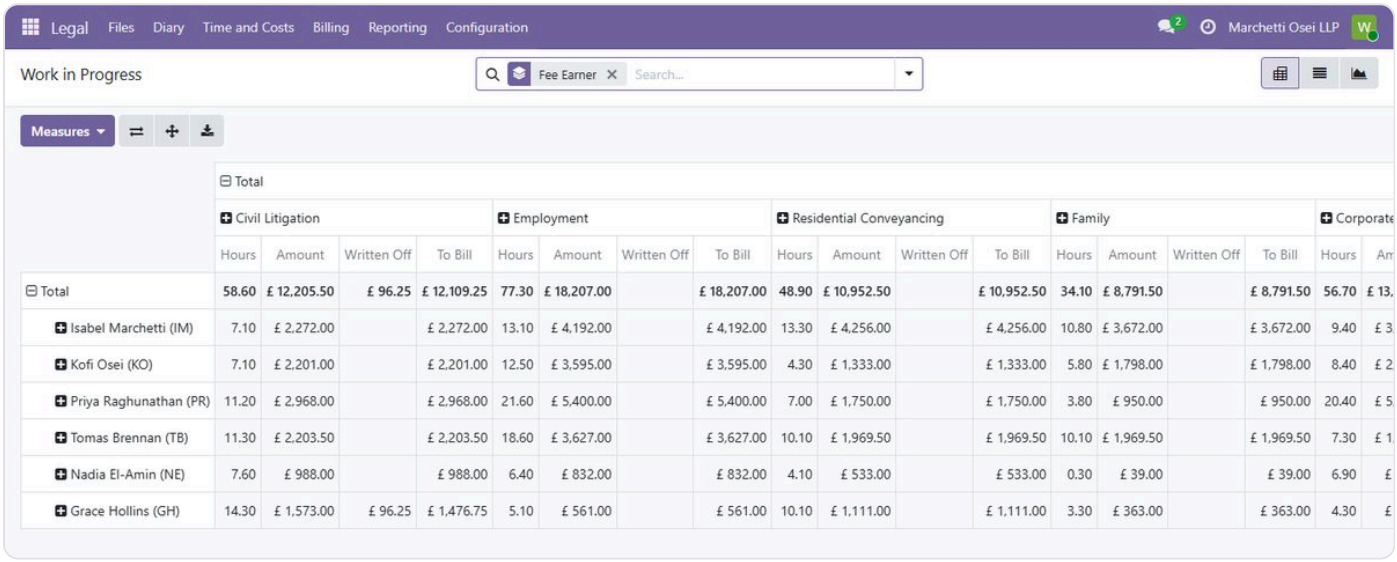
Three reports for the partners, all on live data with nothing to rebuild, and the figures on every matter and fee earner behind them.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Work in progress by fee earner and department
- Realisation and lock-up, and the overnight refresh
- Billing by month, and utilisation against target

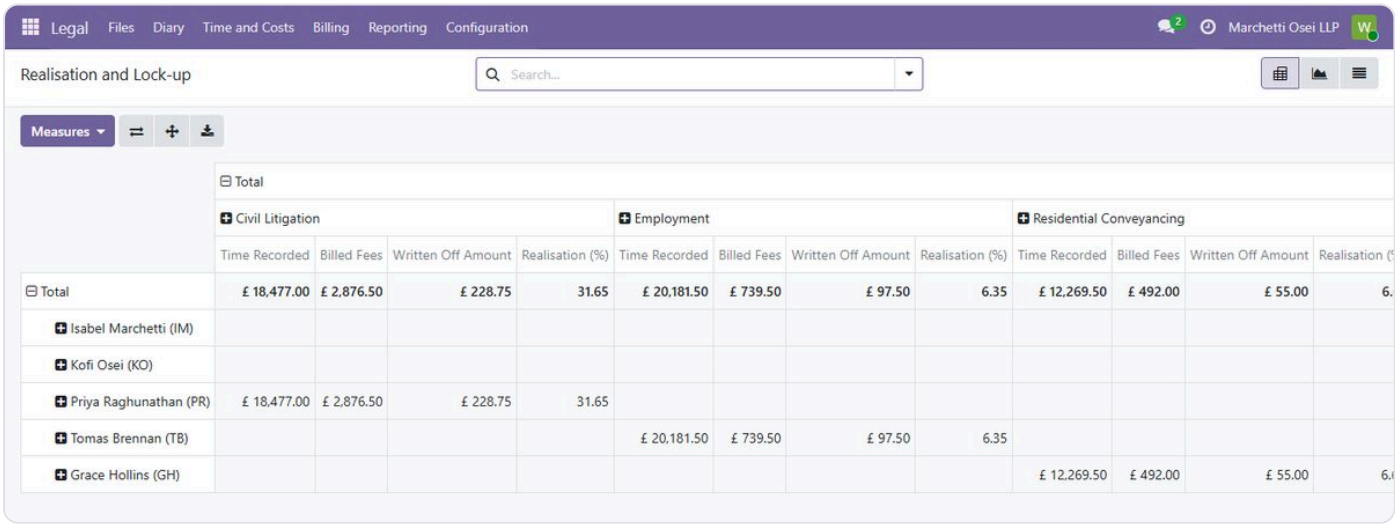
TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

1. Open Reporting, then Work in Progress, and expand a fee earner
2. Open Realisation and Lock-up and switch to the graph



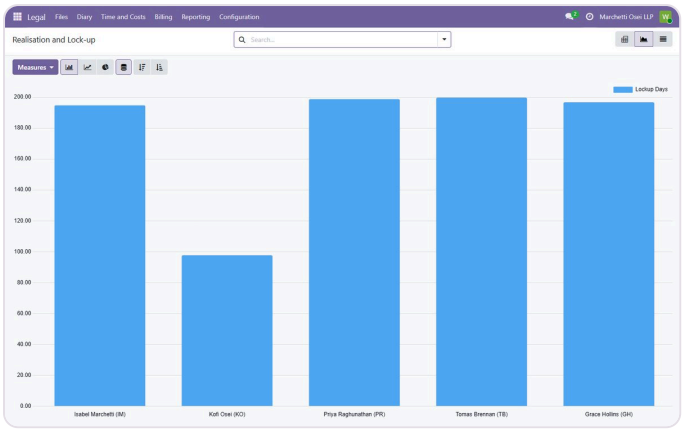
	Total				Civil Litigation				Employment				Residential Conveyancing				Family				Corporate	
	Hours	Amount	Written Off	To Bill	Hours	Amount	Written Off	To Bill	Hours	Amount	Written Off	To Bill	Hours	Amount	Written Off	To Bill	Hours	Amount	Written Off	To Bill	Hours	Am
Total	58.60	£ 12,205.50	£ 96.25	£ 12,109.25	77.30	£ 18,207.00		£ 18,207.00	48.90	£ 10,952.50		£ 10,952.50	34.10	£ 8,791.50		£ 8,791.50	56.70	£ 13,				
Isabel Marchetti (IM)	7.10	£ 2,272.00		£ 2,272.00	13.10	£ 4,192.00		£ 4,192.00	13.30	£ 4,256.00		£ 4,256.00	10.80	£ 3,672.00		£ 3,672.00	9.40	£ 3				
Kofi Osei (KO)	7.10	£ 2,201.00		£ 2,201.00	12.50	£ 3,595.00		£ 3,595.00	4.30	£ 1,333.00		£ 1,333.00	5.80	£ 1,798.00		£ 1,798.00	8.40	£ 2				
Priya Raghunathan (PR)	11.20	£ 2,968.00		£ 2,968.00	21.60	£ 5,400.00		£ 5,400.00	7.00	£ 1,750.00		£ 1,750.00	3.80	£ 950.00		£ 950.00	20.40	£ 5				
Tomas Brennan (TB)	11.30	£ 2,203.50		£ 2,203.50	18.60	£ 3,627.00		£ 3,627.00	10.10	£ 1,969.50		£ 1,969.50	10.10	£ 1,969.50		£ 1,969.50	7.30	£ 1				
Nadia El-Amin (NE)	7.60	£ 988.00		£ 988.00	6.40	£ 832.00		£ 832.00	4.10	£ 533.00		£ 533.00	0.30	£ 39.00		£ 39.00	6.90	£				
Grace Hollins (GH)	14.30	£ 1,573.00	£ 96.25	£ 1,476.75	5.10	£ 561.00		£ 561.00	10.10	£ 1,111.00		£ 1,111.00	3.30	£ 363.00		£ 363.00	4.30	£				

Reporting, then Work in Progress: recorded, chargeable, unbilled time, by fee earner against practice area, with hours, recorded value, written off and to bill. It also opens as a list and a graph.

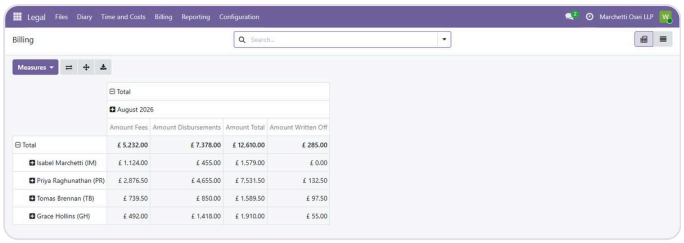


	Total				Civil Litigation				Employment				Residential Conveyancing			
	Time Recorded	Billed Fees	Written Off Amount	Realisation (%)	Time Recorded	Billed Fees	Written Off Amount	Realisation (%)	Time Recorded	Billed Fees	Written Off Amount	Realisation (%				
Total	£ 18,477.00	£ 2,876.50	£ 228.75	31.65	£ 20,181.50	£ 739.50	£ 97.50	6.35	£ 12,269.50	£ 492.00	£ 55.00	6.				
Isabel Marchetti (IM)																
Kofi Osei (KO)																
Priya Raghunathan (PR)	£ 18,477.00	£ 2,876.50	£ 228.75	31.65												
Tomas Brennan (TB)					£ 20,181.50	£ 739.50	£ 97.50	6.35								
Grace Hollins (GH)									£ 12,269.50	£ 492.00	£ 55.00	6.				

Realisation and Lock-up: open, on-hold and closed files by fee earner against practice area, with recorded, billed fees, written off and realisation.

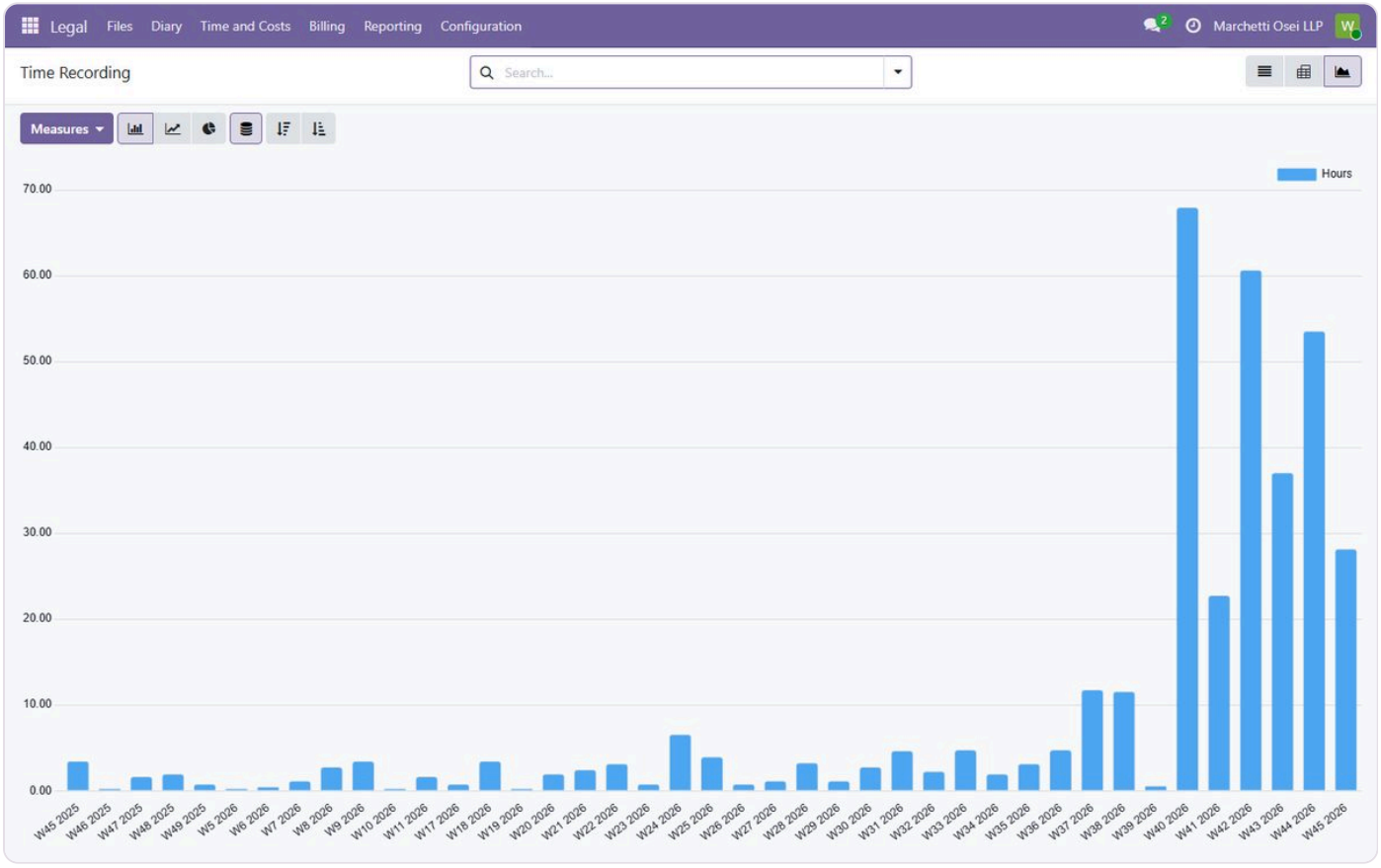


The same report as a graph: lock-up days by fee earner.



Billing: delivered and paid bills by fee earner and month, with fees, disbursements, total and written off.

> Lock-up counts days against today, so it would go stale overnight with nothing on the file changing. A job refreshes it for every live file each night. A second, weekly job raises an "Unbilled work in progress" activity for the fee earner on any open file whose oldest unbilled time is older than the lock-up target, once per file.



Time Recording as a graph: hours recorded per week. Utilisation per fee earner is on the Fee Earners list (Part 4).

PART 15 Printed documents and emails

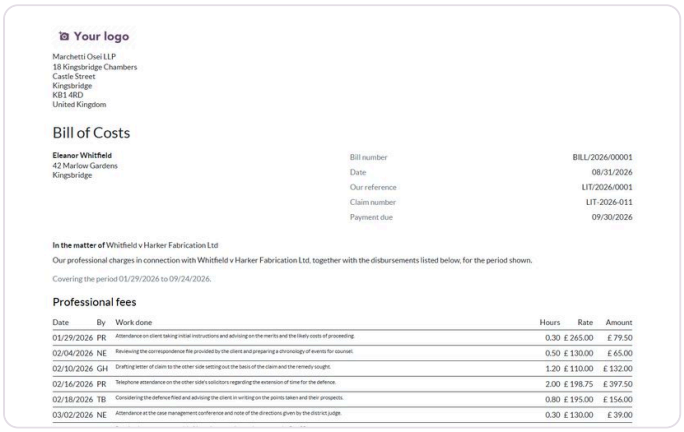
Three documents print from the module, each on the company's own letterhead, and two emails go out from it.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- The bill of costs and how it lays the money out
- The file summary for a file review
- The client account statement with the balance carried down
- The fee note and hearing reminder emails

The bill of costs

Print on a bill, on its own A4 paper format. It names the client and the matter, the covering narrative, then **professional fees** line by line with date, fee earner, work done, hours and amount, any **adjustments to our charges**, and **disbursements** with who was paid and for what. The totals show fees, disbursements and tax apart, the total, any money taken from client account, and what is **now payable**.



Your logo

Marchetti Osei LLP
18 Kingsbridge Chambers
Castle Street
Kingsbridge
KB1 4RD
United Kingdom

Bill of Costs

Eleanor Whitfield
42 Marlow Gardens
Kingsbridge

Bill number	BILL/2026/00001
Date	08/31/2026
Our reference	LIT/2026/0001
Claim number	LIT-2026-011
Payment due	09/30/2026

In the matter of Whitfield v Harker Fabrication Ltd

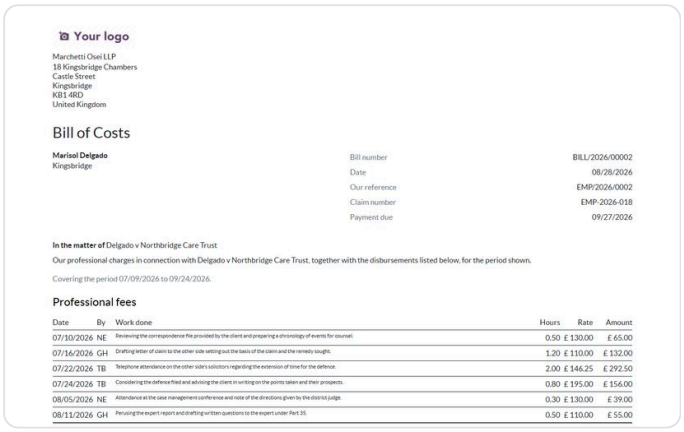
Our professional charges in connection with Whitfield v Harker Fabrication Ltd, together with the disbursements listed below, for the period shown.

Covering the period 01/29/2026 to 09/24/2026.

Professional fees

Date	By	Work done	Hours	Rate	Amount
01/29/2026	PR	Attendance on client taking initial instructions and advising on the merits and the likely costs of proceeding.	0.30	£ 265.00	£ 79.50
02/04/2026	NE	Reviewing the correspondence file provided by the client and preparing a chronology of events for counsel.	0.50	£ 130.00	£ 65.00
02/10/2026	GH	Drafting letter of claim to the other side setting out the basis of the claim and the remedy sought.	1.20	£ 110.00	£ 132.00
02/16/2026	PR	Telephone attendance on the other side's solicitors regarding the extension of time for the defence.	2.00	£ 198.75	£ 397.50
02/18/2026	TB	Considering the defence filed and advising the client in writing on the points taken and their prospects.	0.80	£ 195.00	£ 156.00
03/02/2026	NE	Attendance at the case management conference and note of the directions given by the district judge.	0.30	£ 130.00	£ 39.00

A paid bill, part settled from money on account.



Your logo

Marchetti Osei LLP
18 Kingsbridge Chambers
Castle Street
Kingsbridge
KB1 4RD
United Kingdom

Bill of Costs

Marisol Delgado
Kingsbridge

Bill number	BILL/2026/00002
Date	08/28/2026
Our reference	EMP/2026/0002
Claim number	EMP-2026-018
Payment due	09/27/2026

In the matter of Delgado v Northbridge Care Trust

Our professional charges in connection with Delgado v Northbridge Care Trust, together with the disbursements listed below, for the period shown.

Covering the period 07/09/2026 to 09/24/2026.

Professional fees

Date	By	Work done	Hours	Rate	Amount
07/10/2026	NE	Reviewing the correspondence file provided by the client and preparing a chronology of events for counsel.	0.50	£ 130.00	£ 65.00
07/16/2026	GH	Drafting letter of claim to the other side setting out the basis of the claim and the remedy sought.	1.20	£ 110.00	£ 132.00
07/22/2026	TB	Telephone attendance on the other side's solicitors regarding the extension of time for the defence.	2.00	£ 146.25	£ 292.50
07/24/2026	TB	Considering the defence filed and advising the client in writing on the points taken and their prospects.	0.80	£ 195.00	£ 156.00
08/05/2026	NE	Attendance at the case management conference and note of the directions given by the district judge.	0.30	£ 130.00	£ 39.00
08/11/2026	GH	Perusing the expert report and drafting written questions to the expert under Part 35.	0.50	£ 110.00	£ 55.00

A delivered bill with its disbursements.

The file summary

File Summary on any opened file. Client, practice area, the responsible and supervising fee earners, court and claim number, the dates, the limitation date, the basis of charging and any cap, then the parties, the key dates, where the money is, and the documents on the file. It is what a supervisor reads at a file review.

The client account statement

Print Statement on a client account. Every posted entry in date order with its reference and matter, paid in, paid out, and the balance carried down after each line, ending on the balance held.



Your logo

Marchetti Osei LLP
18 Kingsbridge Chambers
Castle Street
Kingsbridge
KB1 4RD
United Kingdom

Client Account Statement

Ashgrove Developments LLP
CL00003

Balance held: £ 6,922.00
Open

This money is held for you on client account. It is kept apart from the firm's own money and is only ever transferred to us against a bill we have already delivered.

Date	Entry	Detail	Paid in	Paid out	Balance
2026-04-01	CA/2026/000002	Money on Account - FPS 2101077	£ 9,000.00		£ 9,000.00
2026-08-16	CA/2026/000009	Paid Out for the Client - CON/2026/0003 - INV-30563		£ 168.00	£ 8,832.00
2026-09-24	CA/2026/000010	Transfer to Office - CON/2026/0003 - Transfer against BILL/2026/00003		£ 1,910.00	£ 6,922.00

A client account statement.

The two emails

EMAIL	SENT	WHAT IT SAYS
Fee Note	By Email the Fee Note on a delivered or paid bill, to Bill To.	The bill number and matter, with the bill attached, from the fee earner's address (or the company's).
Hearing Reminder	By the daily job, once, inside the warning days of a hearing, completion or appointment, to the client.	What, when and where, our reference, the claim number, counsel, and to call straight away if they cannot attend.

Both are ordinary Odoo email templates and can be reworded in Settings, then Technical, then Email Templates.

PART 16 What runs by itself

Seven scheduled jobs keep the diary, the time, the bills and the lock-up figures honest without anyone remembering to. One file the job cannot handle never stops the rest of the practice.

JOB	HOW OFTEN	WHAT IT DOES
Limitation date warnings	Daily	A To Do activity on the file, due on the limitation date, once a live limitation entry is inside its warning days. Once per entry.
Remind clients about hearings	Daily	Emails the client the Hearing Reminder for a hearing, completion or appointment inside its warning days. Once per entry.
Refresh lock-up days	Daily	Recomputes lock-up and the over target flag on every open or on-hold file.
Chase unbilled work in progress	Weekly	An activity for the fee earner on any open file with WIP older than the lock-up target.
Stop timers left running	Every 4 hours	Stops any timer running over ten hours, caps it at eight, leaves it in draft with a note.
Mark bills paid when the invoice settles	Daily	Marks a delivered bill Paid, on the settlement date, once its invoice is paid or in payment.
Chase overdue bills	Daily	An activity for the fee earner on a delivered bill past its due date. Once per bill.

The rules underneath

Status only by button

Files, bills, time, disbursements and ledger entries move state only through their buttons. Writing the status any other way is refused, so every check above always runs.

Everything on the record

Clients, checks, matters, key dates, time, disbursements, bills and ledger entries all carry the chatter, with changes to status and money tracked.

Multi-company

Every record belongs to a company and is only seen inside it. Each company has its own seven settings.

Tested

The module ships with 146 automated tests covering the rules in this guide.

PART 17 The firm’s website WEBSITE THEME

The lawfirm.way4tech.com demo runs the same Law Firm Management back office with the separate Law Firm Website Theme on Odoo's Website app. The theme is a look and a set of ready pages; it does not connect to the matters, the diary or the client account.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

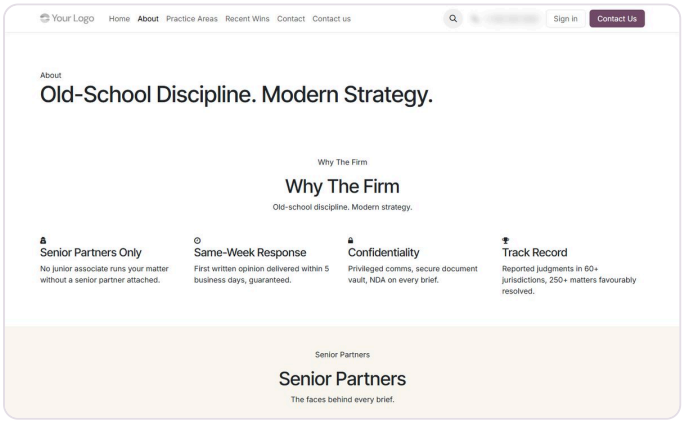
- What the theme installs: a home page and four pages
- The nine drag-and-drop law firm snippets
- The contact form and where enquiries go

TRY IT YOURSELF ON THE DEMO

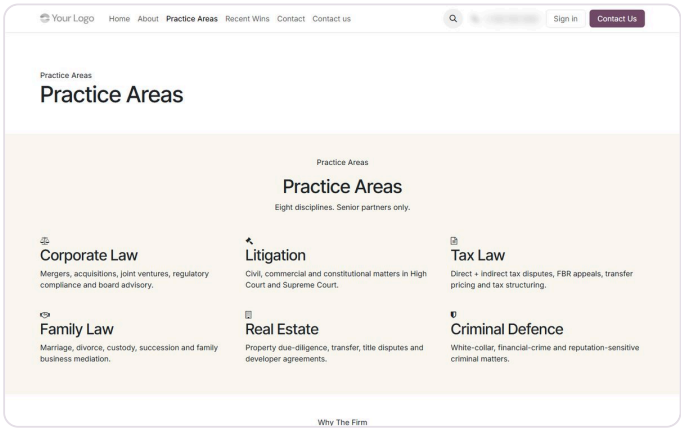
1. Open lawfirm.way4tech.com without signing in
2. Scroll the home page, then open About, Practice Areas, Recent Wins and Contact

Install **Law Firm Website Theme** (wt_theme_lawfirm) from Apps, or pick it when Website asks for a theme. It needs only the Website app. It sets the colours and fonts, replaces the home page, and adds four published pages to the menu: **About** (/about-us), **Practice Areas** (/services), **Recent Wins** (/cases) and **Contact** (/contact).

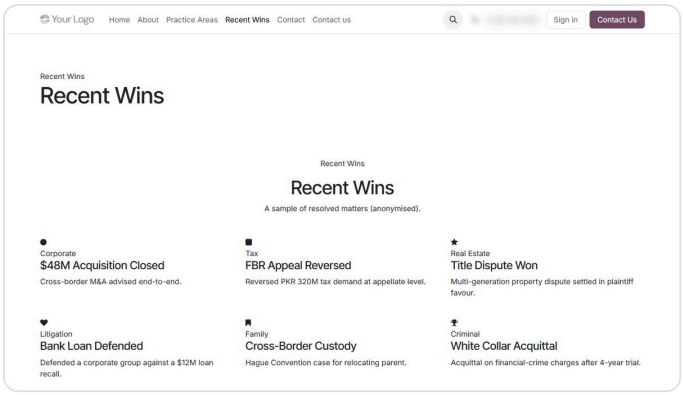
SNIPPET	WHAT IT IS FOR
Hero	The opening banner with the firm's promise and a call to book a consultation.
Practice areas	A card per area of law the firm practises.
Features	Why choose the firm, in short points.
Showcase	Case results and figures.
Team	Partners and lawyers with their roles.
Testimonials	What clients say.
FAQ	Common questions, opening and closing.
Call to action	A band inviting a free first consultation.
Contact	Office details and a form asking name, phone, email, subject and message.



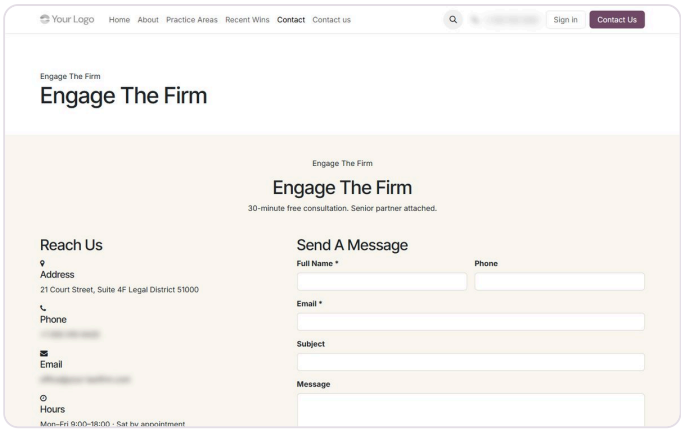
About: why the firm, and the partners. Contact details are blurred in these shots.



Practice Areas.



Recent Wins.



Contact, with the enquiry form.

> The contact form uses Odoo's standard website form and sends the enquiry as an email to the company. It does not create a client or a conflict check; the fee earner raises those from the enquiry (Parts 5 and 6). All text and pictures are edited in the website builder.

PART 18 A fifteen minute walk-through

If you have the demo open and fifteen minutes, this path shows the whole practice. It is also the order to show it to a partner.

#	DO THIS	AND NOTICE
1	Files, then Conflict Checks, open CON/2026/0012	*A prospect whose opponent is already a client of the firm. Conflicted, with the reason recorded.*
2	Open CON/2026/0008	*Three serious matches, each reviewed, an override reason, cleared.*
3	Files, then Matters, open LIT/2026/0011	*An enquiry. Open the File would check the conflict, identity, engagement letter, court and date instructed.*
4	Open LIT/2026/0001 and walk its tabs	*Parties, key dates, time, disbursements, bills, documents, client money, all on one file.*
5	Diary, then Limitation Dates	*Every live limitation date. Open one: it cannot be vacated.*
6	Time and Costs, then Time Recording	*Rates off the rate card, six minute units, a write-down and a write-off with reasons.*
7	Billing, then Bills, open the delivered bill	*Fees, disbursements and tax apart, money from client account, and what is still due.*
8	Billing, then Client Accounts, open one holding money	*A ledger that can never go overdrawn. Print the statement.*
9	Reporting, then Realisation and Lock-up	*Who is billing what they record, and how long the cash is locked up.*
10	Print the bill of costs and a client statement	*What the client reads, and what a file review asks for first.*

Questions people ask

QUESTION	ANSWER
Does it need Odoo Enterprise?	No. It runs on Odoo 19 Community and needs only Invoicing, which it installs. It also installs on Enterprise.
We are not in England. Will it fit?	The working is built around a UK solicitors' practice, but every period, unit and limit is a setting, and it carries no jurisdiction-specific forms or tax rules. Limitation periods are per practice area.
Can clients log in to see their file?	No. There is no client portal. Clients receive the fee note and hearing reminder emails.
Does it store the documents?	It indexes them and holds attachments as ordinary Odoo files. It is not a document management system and does not file at court.
Can a fee earner see another department's files?	No, only their own and those they supervise. The conflict search still looks across every file.
Can we bill a fixed fee?	Record the fee on the file, then bill with an adjustment line for the agreed sum. A capped file is refused a bill past the cap.
Does it reconcile the client account to the bank?	No. It keeps the client ledger and its rules. Bank reconciliation, interest calculation and the accountant's report stay in Accounting or with your accountant.

PART 19 The menu map

Every screen in the module, on one page.

Files

Matters	Every file, from enquiry to closed
Clients	Who the firm acts for, and the due diligence
Conflict Checks	Names searched, matches decided, cleared
Document Register	What is on each file and where originals are

Diary

Key Dates and Hearings	Hearings, deadlines, completions, reviews
Limitation Dates	Every live limitation date in the practice

Time and Costs

Time Recording	Timer, rate card, write-downs and write-offs
Disbursements	Money laid out, from office or client account

Billing

Bills	Gather, approve, deliver, apply money, paid
Client Accounts	One ledger per client, never overdrawn
Client Ledger	Every client money entry (cashier)

Reporting

Work in Progress	Unbilled time by fee earner and department
Realisation and Lock-up	Billed against recorded, days of cash locked up
Billing	Delivered and paid bills by month

Configuration

Settings	The seven practice rules
Fee Earners	People who record time, grades and targets
Rate Card	Rates by fee earner, department and client
Practice Areas	Departments, prefixes, limitation periods
Courts and Tribunals	Where the firm appears, and filing notes
Disbursement Types	Defaults and the recovery account

Want this for your firm?

We set it up with your departments, limitation periods, fee earners and rate card, load your clients and open files, connect your accounts and VAT, and train the fee earners and the cashier. The same module runs a two partner practice or a firm with several offices in separate companies.

way4tech.com · info@way4tech.com